

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12408200
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Bhutani; Ankit et al.

Control device having an adaptive transmission threshold

Abstract

Wireless devices may perform modified carrier sense multiple access (CSMA) techniques in order to increase reliability while maintaining a reasonable latency for communications. The wireless devices may perform listen-before-talk (LBT) techniques using an adaptive transmission threshold (e.g., an adaptive CSMA threshold). The transmission threshold may be compared to a measured signal strength magnitude to determine whether the frequency channel is quiet enough for transmission of a packet. The transmission threshold may be initially set to equal a minimum value. The wireless device may increase the transmission threshold after each instance of LBT failure to allow the wireless device to get progressively more likely to transmit the packet each time LBT fails.

Inventors: Bhutani; Ankit (Aston, PA), Camden; Richard S. (Coopersburg, PA), Newman, Jr.; Robert C. (Emmaus, NJ)

Applicant: Lutron Technology Company LLC (Coopersburg, PA)

Family ID: 76601792

Assignee: Lutron Technology Company LLC (Coopersburg, PA)

Appl. No.: 18/237657

Filed: August 24, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230403736 A1	Dec. 14, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17334111 20210528 US 11785641 child-doc US 18237657
us-provisional-application US 63032024 20200529

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04W74/0808 (20240101); H04B17/318 (20150101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04W74/0808 (20130101); H04B17/318 (20150115);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04B (17/318); H04W (72/08); H04W (84/18)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
7391297	12/2007	Cash et al.	N/A	N/A
8009042	12/2010	Steiner et al.	N/A	N/A
8199010	12/2011	Sloan et al.	N/A	N/A
8228184	12/2011	Blakeley et al.	N/A	N/A
8330638	12/2011	Altonen et al.	N/A	N/A
8410706	12/2012	Steiner et al.	N/A	N/A
8451116	12/2012	Steiner et al.	N/A	N/A
8950461	12/2014	Adams et al.	N/A	N/A
9488000	12/2015	Kirby et al.	N/A	N/A
10264651	12/2018	Steiner	N/A	N/A
2006/0009161	12/2005	Beecher	N/A	N/A
2007/0286122	12/2006	Fonseca	370/329	H04W 72/542
2008/0092075	12/2007	Jacob et al.	N/A	N/A
2012/0286940	12/2011	Carmen et al.	N/A	N/A
2013/0030589	12/2012	Pessina et al.	N/A	N/A
2014/0265568	12/2013	Crafts et al.	N/A	N/A
2015/0163824	12/2014	Krzymien	370/338	H04B 17/382
2018/0167547	12/2017	Casey	N/A	N/A
2018/0176890	12/2017	Moon	N/A	H04W 72/04
2018/0234886	12/2017	Bhorkar et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0274587	12/2020	Jung	N/A	H04W 76/30
2021/0279031	12/2020	Van Erven et al.	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
107852747	12/2017	CN	N/A

Primary Examiner: Jiang; Charles C

Assistant Examiner: Kavleski; Ryan C

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Flaster Greenberg PC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. Non-Provisional patent application Ser. No. 17/334,111, filed May 28, 2021, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,785,641 on Oct. 10, 2023, and which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent App. No. 63/032,024, filed May 29, 2020, entitled CONTROL DEVICE HAVING AN ADAPTIVE TRANSMISSION THRESHOLD, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Lighting control systems may include lighting fixtures that include lighting loads, such as electrical lighting control devices or light emitting diodes, for lighting a space. These lighting fixtures may include a lighting control device, such as a light-emitting diode (LED) driver or electrical ballast, for controlling electrical power to the lighting load. The lighting control system may also include a system controller, or hub, that is capable of sending instructions to the lighting control devices for controlling the electrical power provided to the lighting load. The system controller may send the instructions to the lighting control devices via wireless communication.

(2) There may be many wireless devices (e.g., lighting control devices, load control devices, mobile devices, and/or system controllers) within a given space. For example, in an office building with multiple floors, there may be a system controller for each floor. Each system controller may communicate with multiple lighting control devices on that floor. The system controllers may use the overlapping frequency channels. In addition, there may be other devices in the space that are using frequency channels that overlap with those of the system controllers. Consequently, there may be a relatively large amount of radio-frequency (RF) traffic on the frequency channels used by the system controllers. This may result in the lighting control devices failing to respond to instructions sent from the system controller, or the system controller failing to receive information about the state of the lighting control devices.

SUMMARY

(3) Wireless devices (e.g., load control devices, input devices, mobile devices, and/or system controllers) may perform one or more techniques to increase the reliability of wireless communications in a network while maintaining a reasonable amount of latency. As described herein, a load control system may include load control devices for providing an amount of power to an electrical load. A control device, such as an input device, a system controller or another control device, may send messages including control information to the load control device (e.g., via wireless communication) for providing the amount of power to the electrical load. The load control devices may receive the messages via a communication circuit.

(4) In certain situations, there may be multiple wireless devices using overlapping frequency channels within a relatively small space. For example, a building may have multiple floors, and each floor may have a system controller that controls a large number of lighting control devices. The system controllers on each floor and the associated lighting control devices may use overlapping frequency channels. In addition, there may be other devices (e.g., mobile devices, computers, appliances, wireless access points, etc.) using the same frequency channels. Further, there may be noise sources (e.g., microwaves, motors, security badge readers, etc.) that generate RF energy same frequency channels. There may be a relatively large amount of RF traffic (e.g., RF energy) on the frequency channels, and a consequently large amount of radio frequency interference (RFI). Radio frequency interference may cause the control devices of the load control system to drop packets sent from other control devices in the load control system, thereby decreasing reliability and increasing latency.

(5) The control devices of the load control system may perform a modified carrier sense multiple

access (CSMA) technique in order to increase reliability while maintaining a reasonable latency. For example, the control devices may perform a listen-before-talk (LBT) technique. When using the LBT technique, before sending a packet, a control device may measure a signal strength magnitude (e.g., a received signal strength indicator (RSSI) value) of RF traffic on a given frequency channel. A low value of the measured signal strength magnitude may indicate that the frequency channel is not being used by other control devices (e.g., the frequency channel is quiet), while a high value of the measured signal strength magnitude may indicate that the frequency channel is being used by other control devices (e.g., the frequency channel is occupied). The control device may compare the measured signal strength magnitude to a transmission threshold. If the measured signal strength magnitude is less than the transmission threshold, the control device may transmit the message. If the measured signal strength indicator is not less than the transmission threshold, the control device may wait for a predetermined period of time, and attempt to transmit again after the period of time has elapsed.

(6) Performing CSMA techniques may increase the reliability of transmissions. However, the increase in reliability may come at the expense of latency. For example, if the number of control devices in the load control system is sufficiently large, the frequency channel may be occupied a relatively high percentage of the time, even if the control devices are performing the CSMA technique. There may be a relatively high chance that a given control device will measure a signal strength magnitude that is greater than the transmission threshold. Therefore, the control device may perform the CSMA technique many times before transmitting a message, thus increasing latency. For certain applications, it may be desirable to have a lower latency than can be achieved with the CSMA technique, while still maintaining increased reliability.

(7) The control devices may perform a CSMA technique using an adaptive transmission threshold (e.g., an adaptive CSMA threshold). The control device may measure a signal strength magnitude (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude) of the frequency channel and compare the measured signal strength indicator to the transmission threshold to determine whether the frequency channel is “quiet” enough for transmission of a message. The transmission threshold may be initially set to equal a minimum threshold value. The control device may increase the transmission threshold after each instance of an LBT failure. For example, an LBT failure may occur when the measured signal strength magnitude on the frequency channel fails to be equal to or lower than the transmission threshold. In an example, the control device may increase (e.g., periodically increase) the transmission threshold by an increment (e.g., by a fixed amount, predefined amount, or variable amount) after each instance of LBT failure. Doing so may allow the control device to get progressively more likely to transmit the packet after each instance of LBT failure.

(8) The control device may perform the CSMA technique using a maximum transmission threshold value. The control device may increase the transmission (e.g., by a fixed amount, predefined amount, or variable amount) after each instance of LBT failure. If the transmission threshold reaches or exceeds the maximum threshold value, the control device may transmit the message regardless of the measured signal strength magnitude continuing to exceed the transmission threshold. Alternatively, the control device may count a number of times that the measured signal strength magnitude is greater than the transmission threshold (e.g., the number of times that an LBT failure occurs), and transmit the message after a threshold number of times is reached. The control device may reset the transmission threshold and/or the counted number of times after transmission of the message.

(9) The minimum threshold value and/or the maximum threshold value may be determined based on a priority context of the message. For example, the priority context of the message may be determined based on a type of the control device, a type and/or content of the message, a network role of the control device, and/or a network communication link associated with the message. The priority context may be, for example, latency-critical or latency non-critical. A latency-critical message may be a message for which noticeable or undue delay above a predefined threshold is

unacceptable and/or undesirable. A latency non-critical message may be a message for which noticeable or undue delay above the predefined threshold is acceptable and/or allowed.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a diagram of an example load control system.
- (2) FIG. 1B is a block diagram illustrating an example of a device capable of processing and/or communication in the load control system of FIG. 1A.
- (3) FIG. 1C is a block diagram illustrating an example load control device.
- (4) FIG. 2A is a diagram of an example network that may allow for communication between devices in the load control system of FIG. 1A.
- (5) FIG. 2B is a diagram of example networks or network partitions (e.g., networks or sub-networks) that allow for communication between devices in the load control system of FIG. 1A.
- (6) FIG. 2C is a diagram of another example network that illustrates the cost and network overhead associated with communication between the devices in the load control system of FIG. 1A.
- (7) FIG. 2D is an example table that illustrates example link costs that may correspond to different link qualities.
- (8) FIG. 3 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure for performing a carrier sense multiple access (CSMA) technique with an adaptive transmission threshold.
- (9) FIG. 4 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure for performing a CSMA technique with an adaptive transmission threshold and a maximum threshold value.
- (10) FIG. 5 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure for performing a CSMA technique with an adaptive transmission threshold and a counter.
- (11) FIG. 6 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure for determining a background signal strength magnitude of a frequency channel for updating an adaptive transmission threshold used when performing a CSMA technique.
- (12) FIG. 7 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure for performing CSMA with a minimum threshold value and a maximum threshold value of an adaptive transmission threshold based on a priority context of a message.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (13) FIG. 1A is a diagram of an example load control system **100** for controlling the amount of power delivered from an alternating-current (AC) power source (not shown) to one or more electrical loads. The load control system **100** may be installed in a load control environment **102**. The load control environment **102** may include a space in a residential or commercial building. For example, the load control system **100** may be installed in one or more rooms on one or more floors in the building.
- (14) The load control system **100** may comprise a plurality of control devices. The control devices may include load control devices that are configured to control one or more electrical loads in the load control environment **102** (also referred to as a user environment). For example, the load control devices may control the one or more electrical loads in response to input from one or more input devices or other devices in the load control system **100**.
- (15) The load control devices in the load control system **100** may include lighting control devices. For example, the load control system **100** may include lighting control devices **120** for controlling lighting loads **122** in a corresponding lighting fixture **124**. The lighting control devices **120** may comprise light-emitting diode (LED) drivers and the lighting loads **122** may comprise LED light sources. While each lighting fixture **124** is shown having a single lighting load **122**, each lighting fixture may comprise one or more individual light sources (e.g., lamps and/or LED emitters) that may be controlled individually and/or in unison by the respective lighting control device. Though

an LED driver is provided as an example lighting control device, other types of lighting control devices may be implemented as load control devices in the load control system **100**. For example, the load control system **100** may comprise dimmer switches, electronic dimming ballasts for controlling fluorescent lamps, or other lighting control devices for controlling corresponding lighting loads. The lighting control device **120** may be configured to directly control an amount of power provided to the lighting load **122**. The lighting control device **120** may be configured to receive (e.g., via wired or wireless communications) messages via radio-frequency (RF) signals **108, 109** and to control the lighting load **122** in response to the received messages. One will recognize that lighting control device **120** and lighting load **122** may be integral and thus part of the same fixture or bulb, for example, or may be separate.

(16) The load control devices in the load control system **100** may comprise one or more appliances that are able to receive the RF signals **108, 109** (e.g., wireless signals) for performing load control. In an example, the load control system may include a speaker **146** (e.g., part of an audio/visual or intercom system), which is able to generate audible sounds, such as alarms, music, intercom functionality, etc. in response to RF signals **108, 109**.

(17) The load control devices in the load control system **100** may comprise one or more daylight control devices, e.g., motorized window treatments **150**, such as motorized cellular shades, for controlling the amount of daylight entering the load control environment **102**. Each motorized window treatment **150** may comprise a window treatment fabric **152** hanging from a headrail **154** in front of a respective window **104**. Each motorized window treatment **150** may further comprise a motor drive unit (not shown) located inside of the headrail **154** for raising and lowering the window treatment fabric **152** for controlling the amount of daylight entering the load control environment **102**. The motor drive units of the motorized window treatments **150** may be configured to receive messages via the RF signals **108** and adjust the position of the respective window treatment fabric **152** in response to the received messages. For example, the motorized window treatments may be battery-powered. The load control system **100** may comprise other types of daylight control devices, such as, for example, a cellular shade, a drapery, a Roman shade, a Venetian blind, a Persian blind, a pleated blind, a tensioned roller shade system, an electrochromic or smart window, and/or other suitable daylight control device. Examples of battery-powered motorized window treatments are described in greater detail in U.S. Pat. No. 8,950,461, issued Feb. 10, 2015, entitled **MOTORIZED WINDOW TREATMENT**, and U.S. Pat. No. 9,488,000, issued Nov. 8, 2016, entitled **INTEGRATED ACCESSIBLE BATTERY COMPARTMENT FOR MOTORIZED WINDOW TREATMENT**, the entire disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

(18) The load control devices in the load control system **100** may comprise a plug-in load control device **140** for controlling a plug-in electrical load, e.g., a plug-in lighting load (such as a floor lamp **142** or a table lamp) and/or an appliance (such as a television or a computer monitor). For example, the floor lamp **142** may be plugged into the plug-in load control device **140**. The plug-in load control device **140** may be plugged into a standard electrical outlet **144** and thus may be coupled in series between the AC power source and the plug-in lighting load. The plug-in load control device **140** may be configured to receive messages via the RF signals **108, 109** and to turn on and off or adjust the intensity of the floor lamp **142** in response to the received messages.

(19) The load control devices in the load control system **100** may comprise one or more temperature control devices, e.g., a thermostat **160** for controlling a room temperature in the load control environment **102**. The thermostat **160** may be coupled to a heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) system **162** via a control link **161** (e.g., an analog control link or a wired digital communication link). The thermostat **160** may be configured to wirelessly communicate messages with a controller of the HVAC system **162**. The thermostat **160** may comprise a temperature sensor for measuring the room temperature of the load control environment **102** and may control the HVAC system **162** to adjust the temperature in the room to a setpoint temperature.

The load control system **100** may comprise one or more wireless temperature sensors (not shown) located in the load control environment **102** for measuring the room temperatures. The HVAC system **162** may be configured to turn a compressor on and off for cooling the load control environment **102** and to turn a heating source on and off for heating the rooms in response to the control signals received from the thermostat **160**. The HVAC system **162** may be configured to turn a fan of the HVAC system on and off in response to the control signals received from the thermostat **160**. The thermostat **160** and/or the HVAC system **162** may be configured to control one or more controllable dampers to control the air flow in the load control environment **102**. The thermostat **160** may be configured to receive messages via the RF signals **108**, **109** and adjust heating, ventilation, and cooling in response to the received messages.

(20) The load control system **100** may comprise one or more other types of load control devices, such as, for example, a screw-in luminaire including a dimmer circuit and an incandescent or halogen lamp; a screw-in luminaire including a ballast and a compact fluorescent lamp; a screw-in luminaire including an LED driver and an LED light source; an electronic switch, controllable circuit breaker, or other switching device for turning an appliance on and off; a controllable electrical receptacle, or controllable power strip for controlling one or more plug-in loads; a motor control unit for controlling a motor load, such as a ceiling fan or an exhaust fan; a drive unit for controlling a projection screen; motorized interior or exterior shutters; a thermostat for a heating and/or cooling system; a temperature control device for controlling a setpoint temperature of an HVAC system; an air conditioner; a compressor; an electric baseboard heater controller; a controllable damper; a variable air volume controller; a fresh air intake controller; a ventilation controller; a hydraulic valves for use radiators and radiant heating system; a humidity control unit; a humidifier; a dehumidifier; a water heater; a boiler controller; a pool pump; a refrigerator; a freezer; a television or computer monitor; a video camera; an audio system or amplifier; an elevator; a power supply; a generator; an electric charger, such as an electric vehicle charger; and/or an alternative energy controller.

(21) The load control system **100** may comprise one or more input devices capable of receiving an input event for controlling one or more load control devices in the load control system **100**. The input devices and the load control devices may be collectively referred to as control devices in the load control system **100**. The input devices in the load control system **100** may comprise one or more remote control devices, such as a remote control device **170**. The remote control device may be battery-powered. The remote control device **170** may be configured to transmit messages via RF signals **108** to one or more other devices in the load control system **100** in response to an input event, such as an actuation of one or more buttons or a rotation of a rotary knob of the remote control device **170**. For example, the remote control device **170** may transmit messages to the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatments **150**, and/or the temperature control device **160** via the RF signals **108** in response to actuation of one or more buttons located thereon. The message may include control instructions and/or an indication of the actuation of one or more buttons for controlling a load control device in the load control system **100**. The remote control device **170** may also communicate with other devices in the load control system **100** via a wired communication link. In response to an input event at the remote control device **170**, a devices to which the remote control device **170** is wired may be triggered to transmit messages to one or more other devices in the load control system **100**. The remote control device **170** may comprise a keypad. In another example, the remote control device **170** may comprise a rotary knob configured to transmit messages to one or more other devices in response to a rotation on the rotary knob (e.g., rotation of a predefined distance or for a predefined period of time). The remote control device **170** may be mounted to a structure, such as a wall, a toggle actuator of a mechanical switch, or a pedestal to be located on a horizontal surface. In another example, the remote control device **170** may be handheld. The remote control device **170** may provide feedback (e.g., visual feedback) to a user of the remote control device **170** on a visual

indicator, such as a status indicator. The status indicator may be illuminated by one or more light emitting diodes (LEDs) for providing feedback. The status indicator may provide different types of feedback. The feedback may include feedback indicating actuations by a user or other user interface event, a status of electrical loads being controlled by the remote control device **170**, and/or a status of the load control devices being controlled by the remote control device **170**. The feedback may be displayed in response to user interface event and/or in response to messages received that indicate the status of load control devices and/or electrical loads. Examples of battery-powered remote control devices are described in greater detail in commonly-assigned U.S. Pat. No. 8,330,638, issued Dec. 11, 2012, entitled WIRELESS BATTERY-POWERED REMOTE CONTROL HAVING MULTIPLE MOUNTING MEANS, and U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2012/0286940, published—Nov. 15, 2012, entitled CONTROL DEVICE HAVING A NIGHTLIGHT, the entire disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

(22) The input devices of the load control system **100** may comprise one or more sensor devices, such as a sensor device **141**. The sensor device **141** may be configured to transmit messages via the RF signals **108** to one or more other devices in the load control system **100** in response to an input event, such as a sensor measurement event. The sensor device **141** may also or alternatively be configured to transmit messages via a wired communication link to one or more other devices in the load control system **100** in response to an input event, such as a sensor measurement event. The sensor device **141** may operate as an ambient light sensor or a daylight sensor and may be capable of performing a sensor measurement event by measuring a total light intensity in the space around the sensor device **141**. The sensor device **141** may transmit messages including the measured light level or control instructions generated in response to the measured light level via the RF signals **108**. Examples of RF load control systems having daylight sensors are described in greater detail in commonly assigned U.S. Pat. No. 8,410,706, issued Apr. 2, 2013, entitled METHOD OF CALIBRATING A DAYLIGHT SENSOR; and U.S. Pat. No. 8,451,116, issued May 28, 2013, entitled WIRELESS BATTERY POWERED DAYLIGHT SENSOR, the entire disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

(23) The sensor device **141** may operate as an occupancy sensor configured to detect occupancy and/or vacancy conditions in the load control environment **102**. The sensor device **141** may be capable of performing the sensor measurement event by measuring an occupancy condition or a vacancy condition in response to occupancy or vacancy, respectively, of the load control environment **102** by the user **192**. For example, the sensor device **141** may comprise an infrared (IR) sensor capable of detecting the occupancy condition or the vacancy condition in response to the presence or absence, respectively, of the user **192**. The sensor device **141** may transmit messages including the occupancy conditions or vacancy conditions, or control instructions generated in response to the occupancy/vacancy conditions, via the RF signals **108**. Again, the sensor device **141** may also or alternatively transmit messages including the occupancy conditions or vacancy conditions, or control instructions generated in response to the occupancy/vacancy conditions via a wired communication link. Examples of load control systems having occupancy and vacancy sensors are described in greater detail in commonly-assigned U.S. Pat. No. 8,228,184, issued Jul. 24, 2012, entitled BATTERY-POWERED OCCUPANCY SENSOR, U.S. Pat. No. 8,009,042, issued Aug. 30, 2011 Sep. 3, 2008, entitled RADIO-FREQUENCY LIGHTING CONTROL SYSTEM WITH OCCUPANCY SENSING, and U.S. Pat. No. 8,199,010, issued Jun. 12, 2012, entitled METHOD AND APPARATUS FOR CONFIGURING A WIRELESS SENSOR, the entire disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

(24) The sensor device **141** may operate as a visible light sensor (e.g., including a camera or other device capable of sensing visible light). The sensor device **141** may be capable of performing the sensor measurement event by measuring an amount of visible light within the load control environment **102**. For example, the sensor device **141** may comprise a visible light sensing circuit having an image recording circuit, such as a camera, and an image processing circuit. The image

processing circuit may comprise a digital signal processor (DSP), a microprocessor, a programmable logic device (PLD), a microcontroller, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field-programmable gate array (FPGA), or any suitable processing device capable of processing images or levels of visible light. The sensor device **141** may be positioned towards the load control environment **102** to sense one or more environmental characteristics in the load control environment **102**. The image recording circuit of the sensor device **141** may be configured to capture or record an image. The image recording circuit of the sensor device **141** may provide the captured image to the image processor. The image processor may be configured to process the image into one or more sensed signals that are representative of the sensed environmental characteristics. The sensed environmental characteristics may be interpreted from the sensed signals by the control circuit of the sensor device **141** or the sensed signals may be transmitted to one or more other devices via the RF signals **108**, **109** (e.g., a computing device in the load control environment) for interpreting the sensed environmental characteristics. For example, the sensed environmental characteristics interpreted from the sensed signals may comprise an occurrence of movement, an amount of movement, a direction of movement, a velocity of movement, a counted number of occupants, an occupancy condition, a vacancy condition, a light intensity, a color of visible light, a color temperature of visible light, an amount of direct sunlight penetration, or another environmental characteristic in the load control environment **102**. In another example, the sensor device **141** may provide a raw image or a processed (e.g., preprocessed) image to one or more other devices (e.g., computing devices) in the load control system **100** for further processing. The sensor device **141** may operate as a color temperature sensor when sensing the color temperature of the visible light. Examples of load control systems having visible light sensors are described in greater detail in commonly-assigned U.S. Pat. No. 10,264,651, issued Apr. 16, 2019, entitled LOAD CONTROL, SYSTEM HAVING A VISIBLE LIGHT SENSOR, and U.S. Patent App. Pub. No. 2018/0167547, published Jun. 14, 2018 entitled CONFIGURATION OF A VISIBLE LIGHT SENSOR, the entire disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

(25) The sensor device **141** may be external to the lighting fixtures **124** (e.g., affixed or attached to a ceiling or a wall of the load control environment **102**). The sensor device **141** may be positioned towards the load control environment **102** and may be capable of performing sensor measurement events in the load control environment **102**. In one example, the sensor device **141** may be affixed or attached to a window **104** of the load control environment **102** and operate as a window sensor that is capable performing sensor measurement events on light that is entering the load control environment **102** through the window **104**. For example, the sensor device **141** may comprise an ambient light sensor capable of detecting when sunlight is directly shining into the sensor device **141**, is reflected onto the sensor device **141**, and/or is blocked by external means, such as clouds or a building based on the measured light levels being received by the sensor device **141** from outside the window. The sensor device **141** may send messages indicating the measured light level. Though illustrated as being external to the lighting fixtures **124**, one or more sensor devices **141** may be mounted to one or more of the lighting fixtures **124** (e.g., on a lower or outward-facing surface of the lighting fixture **124**). For example, one or more sensor devices **141** may be electrically coupled to a control circuit or a load control circuit of the load control devices **120** for performing control in response to the sensor measurement events of the sensor devices **141**.

(26) The load control system **100** may comprise other types of input devices, such as, for example, temperature sensors, humidity sensors, radiometers, cloudy-day sensors, shadow sensors, pressure sensors, smoke detectors, carbon monoxide detectors, air-quality sensors, motion sensors, security sensors, proximity sensors, fixture sensors, partition sensors, keypads, multi-zone control units, slider control units, kinetic or solar-powered remote controls, key fobs, cell phones, smart phones, tablets, personal digital assistants, personal computers, laptops, timeclocks, audio-visual controls, safety devices, power monitoring devices (e.g., such as power meters, energy meters, utility submeters, utility rate meters, etc.), central control transmitters, residential, commercial, or

industrial controllers, and/or any combination thereof.

(27) The input devices and the load control devices may be configured to communicate messages between one another on a communication link within the load control system **100**. The communication link between control devices in the load control system may comprise one or more network communication links through which messages may be transmitted for performing end-to-end communications in the load control system **100**. For example, the input devices and the load control devices may be capable of communicating messages directly to one another via the RF signals **108**. The RF signals **108** may be transmitted using a proprietary RF protocol, such as the CLEAR CONNECT protocol (e.g., CLEAR CONNECT TYPE A and/or CLEAR CONNECT TYPE X protocols) and/or a standard protocol, for example, one of WIFI, BLUETOOTH, BLUETOOTH LOW ENERGY (BLE), ZIGBEE, Z-WAVE, THREAD protocols, for a different protocol. In an example, the input devices may transmit messages to the load control devices via the RF signals **108** that comprise input events (e.g., button presses, sensor measurement events, or other input event) or control instructions generated in response to the input events for performing control of the electrical loads controlled by the load control devices. The input devices and the load control devices may be configured to communicate via the RF signals **108** on a first wireless communication link via a first wireless communication protocol (e.g., a wireless network communication protocol, such as THREAD, CLEAR CONNECT TYPE A, CLEAR CONNECT TYPE X, WIFI, etc.) and communicate via the RF signals **109** on a second wireless communication link via a second wireless communication protocol (e.g., a short-range wireless communication protocol, such as BLUETOOTH, BLE, etc.). Though communication links may be described as a wireless communication links, wired communication links may similarly be implemented for enabling communications herein.

(28) For devices in the load control system **100** to recognize messages directed to the device and/or to which to be responsive, the devices may be associated with one another by performing an association procedure. For example, for a load control device to be responsive to messages from an input device, the input device may first be associated with the load control device. As one example of an association procedure, devices may be put in an association mode for sharing a unique identifier for being associated with and/or stored at other devices in the load control system **100**. For example, an input device and a load control device may be put in an association mode by the user **192** actuating a button on the input device and/or the load control device. The actuation of the button on the input device and/or the load control device may place the input device and/or the load control device in the association mode for being associated with one another. In the association mode, the input device may transmit an association message(s) to the load control device (directly or through one or more other devices as described herein). The association message from the input device may include a unique identifier of the input device. The load control device may locally store the unique identifier of the input device in association information, such that the load control device may be capable of recognizing messages (e.g., subsequent messages) from the input device that may include load control instructions or commands. The association information stored at the load control device may include the unique identifiers of the devices with which the load control device is associated. The load control device may be configured to respond to the messages from the associated input device by controlling a corresponding electrical load according to the load control instructions received in the messages. The input device may also store the unique identifier of the load control device with which it is being associated in association information stored locally thereon. A similar association procedure may be performed between other devices in the load control system **100** to enable each device to perform communication of messages with associated devices. This is merely one example of how devices may communicate and be associated with one another and other examples are possible.

(29) According to another example, one or more devices may receive system configuration data (e.g., or subsequent updates to the system configuration data) that is uploaded to the devices and

that specifies the association information comprising the unique identifiers of the devices for being associated. The system configuration data may comprise a load control dataset that defines the devices and operational settings of the load control system **100**. The system configuration data may include information about the devices in the user environment **102** and/or the load control system **100**, including configuration identifiers (e.g., fixture identifiers or load control device identifiers, groups, zones, areas, and/or location identifiers) of the control devices. For example, the system configuration data may include association information that indicates defined associations between devices in the load control system **100**. The association information may be updated using any of the association procedures described herein.

(30) One or more intermediary devices may also maintain association information that includes the unique identifiers that make up the associations of other devices in the load control system **100**. For example, the input devices and the load control devices may communicate on a communication link in the load control system **100** through one or more other intermediary devices, such as router devices or other devices in a network. The intermediary devices may comprise input devices, load control devices, a central processing device, or another intermediary device capable of enabling communication between devices in the load control system. The association information that is maintained on the intermediary devices may comprise the unique identifiers of the devices that are associated with one another for identifying and/or enabling communication of messages between devices in the load control system **100**. For example, an intermediary device may identify the unique identifiers being transmitted in association messages between devices during the association procedure and store the unique identifiers of the devices as an association in the association information. The intermediary devices may use the association information for monitoring and/or routing communications on a communication link between devices in the load control system **100**. In another example, the association information of other devices may be uploaded to the intermediary device and/or communicated from the intermediary device to the other devices for being locally stored thereon (e.g., at the input devices and/or load control devices).

(31) The load control system **100** may comprise a system controller **110**. The system controller **100** may operate as an intermediary device, as described herein. For example, the system controller **110** may operate as a central processing device for one or more other devices in the load control system **100**. The system controller **110** may be operable to communicate messages to and from the control devices (e.g., the input devices and the load control devices). For example, the system controller **110** may be configured to receive messages from the input devices and transmit messages to the load control devices in response to the messages received from the input devices. The system controller **110** may route the messages based on the association information stored thereon. The input devices, the load control devices, and the system controller **110** may be configured to transmit and receive the RF signals **108** and/or over a wired communication link. The system controller **110** may be coupled to one or more networks, such as a wireless or wired local area network (LAN), e.g., for access to the Internet. The system controller **110** may be wirelessly connected to the networks using one or more wireless protocols. The system controller **110** may be coupled to the networks via a wired communication link, such as a network communication bus (e.g., an Ethernet communication link).

(32) The system controller **110** may be configured to communicate via the network with one or more computing devices, e.g., a mobile device **190**, such as, a personal computing device and/or a wearable wireless device. The mobile device **190** may be located on an occupant **192**, for example, may be attached to the occupant's body or clothing or may be held by the occupant. The mobile device **190** may be characterized by a unique identifier (e.g., a serial number or address stored in memory) that uniquely identifies the mobile device **190** and thus the occupant **192**. Examples of personal computing devices may include a smart phone, a laptop, and/or a tablet device. Examples of wearable wireless devices may include an activity tracking device, a smart watch, smart clothing, and/or smart glasses. In addition, the system controller **110** may be configured to

communicate via the network with one or more other control systems (e.g., a building management system, a security system, etc.).

(33) The mobile device **190** may be configured to transmit messages to the system controller **110**, for example, in one or more Internet Protocol packets. For example, the mobile device **190** may be configured to transmit messages to the system controller **110** over the LAN and/or via the Internet. The mobile device **190** may be configured to transmit messages over the Internet to an external service, and then the messages may be received by the system controller **110**. The mobile device **190** may transmit and receive RF signals **109**. The RF signals **109** may be the same signal type and/or transmitted using the same protocol as the RF signals **108**. Alternatively, or additionally, the mobile device **190** may be configured to transmit RF signals according to another signal type and/or protocol. The mobile device **190** and/or the system controller **110** may be capable of communicating on communication links with other devices via RF signals **108**, **109**.

(34) The load control system **100** may comprise other types of computing devices coupled to the network, such as a desktop personal computer (PC), a wireless-communication-capable television, or any other suitable Internet-Protocol-enabled device. Examples of load control systems operable to communicate with mobile and/or computing devices on a network are described in greater detail in commonly-assigned U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2013/0030589, published Jan. 31, 2013, entitled LOAD CONTROL DEVICE HAVING INTERNET CONNECTIVITY, the entire disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference.

(35) The operation of the load control system **100** may be programmed and configured using, for example, the mobile device **190** or other computing device (e.g., when the mobile device is a personal computing device). The mobile device **190** may execute a graphical user interface (GUI) configuration software for allowing a user **192** to program how the load control system **100** will operate. For example, the configuration software may run as a PC application or a web interface. The configuration software and/or the system controller **110** (e.g., via instructions from the configuration software) may generate the system configuration data that may include the load control dataset that defines the operation of the load control system **100**. For example, the load control dataset may include information regarding the operational settings of different load control devices of the load control system (e.g., the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatments **150**, and/or the thermostat **160**). The load control dataset may comprise information regarding how the load control devices respond to inputs received from the input devices. Examples of configuration procedures for load control systems are described in greater detail in commonly-assigned U.S. Pat. No. 7,391,297, issued Jun. 24, 2008, entitled HANDHELD PROGRAMMER FOR A LIGHTING CONTROL SYSTEM; U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2008/0092075, published Apr. 17, 2008, entitled METHOD OF BUILDING A DATABASE OF A LIGHTING CONTROL SYSTEM; and U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2014/0265568, published Sep. 18, 2014, entitled COMMISSIONING LOAD CONTROL SYSTEMS.

(36) FIG. 1B is a block diagram illustrating an example of a device **130** capable of processing and/or communication in a load control system, such as the load control system **100** of FIG. 1A. In an example, the device **130** may be a control device capable of transmitting or receiving messages. The control device may be in an input device, such as a sensor device **141** (e.g., an occupancy sensor or another sensor device), a remote control device **170**, or another input device capable of transmitting messages to load control devices or other devices in the load control system **100**. The device **130** may be a computing device, such as the mobile device **190**, the system controller **110**, a processing device, a central computing device, or another computing device in the load control system **100**.

(37) The device **130** may include a control circuit **131** for controlling the functionality of the device **130**. The control circuit **131** may include one or more general purpose processors, special purpose processors, conventional processors, digital signal processors (DSPs), microprocessors, integrated

circuits, a programmable logic device (PLD), application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), or the like. The control circuit **131** may perform signal coding, data processing, image processing, power control, input/output processing, or any other functionality that enables the device **131** to perform as one of the devices of the load control system (e.g., load control system **100**) described herein.

(38) The control circuit **131** may be communicatively coupled to a memory **132** to store information in and/or retrieve information from the memory **132**. The memory **132** may comprise a computer-readable storage media or machine-readable storage media that maintains a device dataset of associated device identifiers, network information, and/or computer-executable instructions for performing as described herein. For example, the memory **132** may comprise computer-executable instructions or machine-readable instructions that include one or more portions of the procedures described herein. The procedures may enable the device **130** and/or other devices to perform one or more CSMA techniques using adaptive transmission thresholds, as described herein. The procedures may also enable the device **130** and/or other devices to determine background signal strengths, as described herein. The control circuit **131** may access the instructions from memory **132** for being executed to cause the control circuit **131** to operate as described herein, or to operate one or more other devices as described herein.

(39) The memory **132** may include a non-removable memory and/or a removable memory. The non-removable memory may include random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), a hard disk, or any other type of non-removable memory storage. The removable memory may include a subscriber identity module (SIM) card, a memory stick, a memory card, or any other type of removable memory. The memory **132** may be implemented as an external integrated circuit (IC) or as an internal circuit of the control circuit **131**.

(40) The device **130** may include one or more communication circuits **134** that are in communication with the control circuit **131** for sending and/or receiving information as described herein. The communication circuit **134** may perform wireless and/or wired communications. The communication circuit **134** may be a wired communication circuit capable of communicating on a wired communication link. The wired communication link may include an Ethernet communication link, an RS-485 serial communication link, a 0-10 volt analog link, a pulse-width modulated (PWM) control link, a Digital Addressable Lighting Interface (DALI) digital communication link, and/or another wired communication link. The communication circuit **134** may be configured to communicate via power lines (e.g., the power lines from which the device **130** receives power) using a power line carrier (PLC) communication technique. The communication circuit **134** may be a wireless communication circuit including one or more RF or infrared (IR) transmitters, receivers, transceivers, and/or other communication circuits capable of performing wireless communications.

(41) Though a single communication circuit **134** may be illustrated, multiple communication circuits may be implemented in the device **130**. The device **130** may include a communication circuit configured to communicate via one or more wired and/or wireless communication networks and/or protocols and at least one other communication circuit configured to communicate via one or more other wired and/or wireless communication networks and/or protocols. For example, a first communication circuit may be configured to communicate via a wired or wireless communication link, while another communication circuit may be capable of communicating on another wired or wireless communication link. The first communication circuit may be configured to communicate via a first wireless communication link (e.g., a wireless network communication link) using a first wireless protocol (e.g., a wireless network communication protocol, and the second communication circuit may be configured to communicate via a second wireless communication link (e.g., a short-range or direct wireless communication link) using a second wireless protocol (e.g., a short-range wireless communication protocol).

(42) One of the communication circuits **134** may comprise a beacon transmitting and/or receiving circuit capable of transmitting and/or receiving beacon messages via a short-range RF signal. The

control circuit **131** may communicate with beacon transmitting circuit (e.g., a short-range communication circuit) to transmit beacon messages. The beacon transmitting circuit may communicate beacons via RF communication signals, for example. The beacon transmitting circuit may be a one-way communication circuit (e.g., the beacon transmitting circuit is configured to transmit beacon messages) or a two-way communication circuit capable of receiving information on the same network and/or protocol on which the beacons are transmitted (e.g., the beacon transmitting circuit is configured to transmit and receive beacon messages). The information received at the beacon transmitting circuit may be provided to the control circuit **131**.

(43) The control circuit **131** may be in communication with one or more input circuits **133** from which inputs may be received. The input circuits **133** may be included in a user interface for receiving inputs from the user. For example, the input circuits **133** may include an actuator (e.g., a momentary switch that may be actuated by one or more physical buttons) that may be actuated by a user to communicate user input or selections to the control circuit **131**. In response to an actuation of the actuator, the control circuit **131** may enter an association mode, transmit association messages from the device **130** via the communication circuits **134**, and/or receive other information (e.g., control instructions for performing control of an electrical load). In response to an actuation of the actuator, the control circuit may be configured to perform control by transmitting control instructions indicating the actuation on the user interface and/or the control instructions generated in response to the actuation. The actuator may include a touch sensitive surface, such as a capacitive touch surface, a resistive touch surface an inductive touch surface, a surface acoustic wave (SAW) touch surface, an infrared touch surface, an acoustic pulse touch surface, or another touch sensitive surface that is configured to receive inputs (e.g., touch actuations/inputs), such as point actuations or gestures from a user. The control circuit **131** of the device **130** may enter the association mode, transmit an association message, transmit control instructions, or perform other functionality in response to an actuation or input from the user on the touch sensitive surface.

(44) The input circuits **133** may include a sensing circuit (e.g., a sensor). The sensing circuit may be an occupant sensing circuit, a temperature sensing circuit, a color (e.g., color temperature) sensing circuit, a visible light sensing circuit (e.g., a camera), a daylight sensing circuit or ambient light sensing circuit, or another sensing circuit for receiving input (e.g., sensing an environmental characteristic in the environment of the device **130**). The control circuit **131** may receive information from the one or more input circuits **133** and process the information for performing functions as described herein.

(45) The control circuit **131** may be in communication with one or more output sources **135**. The output sources **135** may include one or more indicators (e.g., visible indicators, such as LEDs) for providing indications (e.g., feedback) to a user. The output sources **135** may include a display (e.g., a visible display) for providing information (e.g., feedback) to a user. The control circuit **131** and/or the display may generate a graphical user interface (GUI) generated via software for being displayed on the device **130** (e.g., on the display of the device **130**).

(46) The user interface of the device **130** may combine features of the input circuits **133** and the output sources **135**. For example, the user interface may have buttons that actuate the actuators of the input circuits **133** and may have indicators (e.g., visible indicators) that may be illuminated by the light sources of the output sources **135**. In another example, the display and the control circuit **131** may be in two-way communication, as the display may display information to the user and include a touch screen capable of receiving information from a user. The information received via the touch screen may be capable of providing the indicated information received from the touch screen as information to the control circuit **131** for performing functions or control.

(47) Each of the hardware circuits within the device **130** may be powered by a power source **136**. The power source **136** may include a power supply configured to receive power from an alternating-current (AC) power supply or direct-current (DC) power supply, for example. In addition, the power source **136** may comprise one or more batteries. The power source **136** may

produce a supply voltage V.sub.CC for powering the hardware within the device **130**.

(48) FIG. 1C is a block diagram illustrating an example load control device **180**. The load control device **180** may be a lighting control device (e.g., the lighting control device **120**), a motorized window treatment (e.g., the motorized window treatments **150**), a plug-in load control device (e.g., the plug-in load control device **140**), a temperature control device (e.g., the temperature control device **160**), a dimmer switch, an electronic switch, an electronic ballast for lamps, and/or another load control device.

(49) The load control device **180** may include a control circuit **181** for controlling the functionality of the load control device **180**. The control circuit **181** may include one or more general purpose processors, special purpose processors, conventional processors, digital signal processors (DSPs), microprocessors, integrated circuits, a programmable logic device (PLD), application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), or the like. The control circuit **181** may perform signal coding, data processing, image processing, power control, input/output processing, or any other functionality that enables the load control device **180** to perform as one of the devices of the load control system (e.g., load control system **100**) described herein.

(50) The load control device **180** may include a load control circuit **185** that may be electrically coupled in series between a power source **187** (e.g., an AC power source and/or a DC power source) and an electrical load **188**. The control circuit **181** may be configured to control the load control circuit **185** for controlling the electrical load **188**, for example, in response to received instructions. The electrical load **188** may include a lighting load, a motor load (e.g., for a ceiling fan and/or exhaust fan), an electric motor for controlling a motorized window treatment, a component of a heating, ventilation, and cooling (HVAC) system, a speaker, or any other type of electrical load. The electrical load may **188** be included in or external to the load control device **180**. For example, the load control device **180** may be a dimmer switch or an LED driver capable of controlling an external lighting load. The electrical load **188** may be integral with the load control device **180**. For example, the load control device **180** may be included in LEDs of a controllable light source, a motor of a motor drive unit, or a speaker in a controllable audio device.

(51) The control circuit **181** may be communicatively coupled to a memory **182** to store information in and/or retrieve information from the memory **182**. The memory **182** may comprise a computer-readable storage media or machine-readable storage media that maintains a device dataset of associated device identifiers, network information, and/or computer-executable instructions for performing as described herein. For example, the memory **132** may comprise computer-executable instructions or machine-readable instructions that include one or more portions of the procedures described herein. The procedures may enable the load control device **180** and/or other devices to perform one or more CSMA techniques using adaptive transmission thresholds, as described herein. The procedures may also enable the load control device **180** and/or other devices to determine background signal strengths, as described herein.

(52) The control circuit **181** may access the instructions from memory **182** for being executed to cause the control circuit **181** to operate as described herein, or to operate one or more devices as described herein. The memory **182** may include a non-removable memory and/or a removable memory. The non-removable memory may include random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), a hard disk, or any other type of non-removable memory storage. The removable memory may include a subscriber identity module (SIM) card, a memory stick, a memory card, or any other type of removable memory. The memory **182** may be implemented as an external integrated circuit (IC) or as an internal circuit of the control circuit **181**.

(53) The load control device **180** may include one or more communication circuits **184** that are in communication with the control circuit **181** for sending and/or receiving information as described herein. The communication circuit **184** may perform wireless and/or wired communications. The communication circuit **184** may be a wired communication circuit capable of communicating on a wired communication link. The wired communication link may include an Ethernet communication

link, an RS-485 serial communication link, a 0-10 volt analog link, a pulse-width modulated (PWM) control link, a Digital Addressable Lighting Interface (DALI) digital communication link, and/or another wired communication link. The communication circuit **184** may be configured to communicate via power lines (e.g., the power lines from which the load control device **180** receives power) using a power line carrier (PLC) communication technique. The communication circuit **184** may be a wireless communication circuit including one or more RF or IR transmitters, receivers, transceivers, or other communication circuits capable of performing wireless communications.

(54) Though a single communication circuit **184** may be illustrated, multiple communication circuits may be implemented in the load control device **180**. The load control device **180** may include a communication circuit configured to communicate via one or more wired and/or wireless communication networks and/or protocols and at least one other communication circuit configured to communicate via one or more other wired and/or wireless communication networks and/or protocols. For example, a first communication circuit may be configured to communicate via a wired or wireless communication link, while another communication circuit may be capable of communicating on another wired or wireless communication link. The first communication circuit may be configured to communicate via a first wireless communication link (e.g., a wireless network communication link) using a first wireless protocol (e.g., a wireless network communication protocol), and the second communication circuit may be configured to communicate via a second wireless communication link (e.g., a short-range or direct wireless communication link) using a second wireless protocol (e.g., a short-range wireless communication protocol).

(55) One of the communication circuits **184** may comprise a beacon transmitting and/or receiving circuit capable of transmitting and/or receiving beacon messages via a short-range RF signal. A control circuit **181** may communicate with beacon transmitting circuit (e.g., a short-range communication circuit) to transmit beacon messages. The beacon transmitting circuit may communicate beacon messages via RF communication signals, for example. The beacon transmitting circuit may be a one-way communication circuit (e.g., the beacon transmitting circuit is configured to transmit beacon messages) or a two-way communication circuit capable of receiving information on the same network and/or protocol on which the beacon messages are transmitted (e.g., the beacon transmitting circuit is configured to transmit and receive beacon messages). The information received at the beacon transmitting circuit may be provided to the control circuit **181**.

(56) The control circuit **181** may be in communication with one or more input circuits **183** from which inputs may be received. The input circuits **183** may be included in a user interface for receiving inputs from the user. For example, the input circuits **183** may include an actuator (e.g., a momentary switch that may be actuated by one or more physical buttons) that may be actuated by a user to communicate user input or selections to the control circuit **181**. In response to an actuation of the actuator, the control circuit **181** may enter an association mode, transmit association messages from the load control device **180** via the communication circuits **184**, and/or receive other information. In response to an actuation of the actuator may perform control by controlling the load control circuit **185** to control the electrical load **188**, and/or by transmitting control instructions indicating the actuation on the user interface and/or the control instructions generated in response to the actuation. The actuator may include a touch sensitive surface, such as a capacitive touch surface, a resistive touch surface an inductive touch surface, a surface acoustic wave (SAW) touch surface, an infrared touch surface, an acoustic pulse touch surface, or another touch sensitive surface that is configured to receive inputs (e.g., touch actuations/inputs), such as point actuations or gestures from a user. The control circuit **181** of the load control device **180** may enter the association mode, transmit an association message, control the load control circuit **185**, transmit control instructions, or perform other functionality in response to an actuation or input from the user on the touch sensitive surface.

(57) The input circuits **183** may include a sensing circuit (e.g., a sensor). The sensing circuit may be an occupant sensing circuit, a temperature sensing circuit, a color (e.g., color temperature) sensing circuit, a visible light sensing circuit (e.g., a camera), a daylight sensing circuit or ambient light sensing circuit, or another sensing circuit for receiving input (e.g., sensing an environmental characteristic in the environment of the load control device **180**). The control circuit **181** may receive information from the one or more input circuits **183** and process the information for performing functions as described herein.

(58) The control circuit **181** may illuminate a light sources **186** (e.g., LEDs) to provide feedback to a user. The control circuit **181** may be operable to illuminate the light sources **186** different colors. The light sources **186** may be illuminated by, for example, one or more light-emitting diodes (LEDs).

(59) Referring again to FIG. **1A**, a network may be used to facilitate communication between the respective devices (e.g., control devices) of the load control system **100**. Control devices may communicate with each other via a network by first joining the network and then attaching to another control device on the network (e.g., to form a mesh network). When the lighting control system is initially installed, the control devices may join network (e.g., by exchanging credentials with a network commissioning device). The control devices may each then attempt to attach to another control device network to form the mesh network (e.g., formation of the network). In order to attach to another control device on the network, the control device may send and receive a number of messages via the network.

(60) FIG. **2A** is an illustration of an example network **200** that may allow for communication between devices in a load control system (e.g., the load control system **100**). The network **200** may include any suitable network to facilitate communications in a load control system or an Internet of Things (IoT) environment. The various control devices of the load control system **100** may communicate with each other via the network **200**. As shown in FIG. **2A**, the network **200** may comprise a single network partition. In addition, the network **200** may be an example of a network partition (e.g., a subnetwork or subnet) within a larger network. For example, the network **200** may be an example of a network partition within a larger network composed of a plurality of network partitions. The network **200** is an example network and the techniques described herein may be applied to other networks, for example, that include more devices or less devices than the network **200**.

(61) The circled nodes of FIG. **2A** may represent devices that are attached to other devices on the network **200** (e.g., the various control devices of the load control system **100**). A control device that is attached to at least one other control device on the network **200** may communicate with the other control devices (e.g., that are attached to another control device on the network **200**).

Communication within the network **200** may be facilitated by the network communication links (e.g., attachments) established within the network **200**. Referring to FIG. **2A**, the network communication links between the control devices may be indicated by lines (e.g., double solid lines, single solid lines, and single dashed lines) that connect the respective devices.

(62) The control devices attached to at least one other device on the network **200** may take on and/or be assigned a respective role in the network. For example, the roles may include: a leader device (e.g., leader device **210**), a router device (e.g., router devices **220a-220d**), an end device (e.g., end devices **230a** and **230b**), a router eligible end device (REED) (e.g., router eligible end device **240**), a parent device, a child device and/or a sleepy end device (e.g., sleepy end device **250**). The role of a control device may indicate the functions and/or capabilities of the control device with respect to the network **200**.

(63) As illustrated in FIG. **2A**, the network **200** may include a leader device **210**. The leader device **210** may manage other control devices attached to the network **200**. For example, the leader device **210** may assign and maintain router identifiers (e.g., router IDs) for each of the router devices **220**. For example, each of the router devices **220a-220d** may be assigned a unique router identifier. The

leader device **210** may assign and maintain the roles of other devices. The leader device **210** may be configured as the gateway for the network **200**. For example, the leader device may facilitate communication (e.g., route and receives messages to and from) between the network **200** and other networks or network partitions. Referring to FIG. 1A, a system controller (e.g., the system controller **110** shown in FIG. 1A) may be an example of a leader device **210**. In addition, a control device within a load control system that is capable of being assigned to the role of a router device may be assigned to the role of the leader device (e.g., a control device).

(64) The network **200** may include one or more router devices **220a-220d**. The leader device **210** may support and be attached to multiple router devices (e.g., more than 30 router devices). The leader device **210** may operate as a router device. The router devices **220a-220d** on the network **200** (e.g., attached to the leader device **210** on the network **200**) may be in communication with each other, for example, to form a mesh network. The router devices **220a-220d** may be in communication with one another (e.g., as indicated by the double solid lines connecting the router devices **220a-220d**). The router devices **220a-220d** may be in communication with the leader device **210**, either directly or through one or more other router devices (e.g., as indicated by the double solid lines connecting the leader device **210** to the router devices **220a** and **220c**). The router devices **220a-220d** may receive and route messages to other devices on the network **200** (e.g., the end devices **230a**, **230b**, the router eligible end device **240**, and/or the sleepy end device **250**). For example, the router devices **220a-220d** may receive/transmit messages between devices, or between each other for communicating messages received from an attached device to another device attached to another router device. Referring now to the load control system **100** of FIG. 1A, a control device that is, for example, externally powered (e.g., a control device that is not battery powered) may be assigned to the role of a router device, such as, the system controller **110** the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatments **150**, and/or the thermostat **160**.

(65) Referring again to FIG. 2A, the network **200** may include one or more end devices **230a**, **230b** (e.g., full or minimal end devices). The end devices **230a**, **230b** may be attached to another device (e.g., a parent device, such as the leader device **210** or router devices **220a**, **220b**, **220c**, **220d**) on the network **200** and may transmit and/or receive messages via an attached router device **220a-220d**. Though two end devices **230a**, **230b** are shown in FIG. 2A, and each is attached to different router devices, each router device **220a-220d** may support multiple end devices (e.g., more than 500 end devices). Referring again to the system **100** shown in FIG. 1A, the system controller **110**, input devices (e.g., the remote control device **170** and/or sensor device **141**), and/or load control devices (e.g. the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatments **150**, and/or the thermostat **160**) may be examples of the end devices **230a**, **230b**.

(66) Referring again to FIG. 2A, the network **200** may include the router eligible end device **240**. The router eligible end device **240** may be an end device that is capable (e.g., hardware capable and/or software capable) of becoming a leader device and/or a router device. In certain situations, the role of the router eligible end device **240** may be updated to a leader device and/or a router device. For example, when the router eligible end device **240** identifies itself as being within reach of an end device attempting to attach to the network **200**, the router eligible end device **240** may upgrade itself to the role of a router device. The router eligible end device **240** may transmit and/or receive messages via an attached router device **220d**. As shown in FIG. 2A, the router eligible end device **240** may be one of the end devices that is attached to the router device **220d**. Referring to FIG. 1A, the system controller **110**, the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatments **150**, and/or the thermostat **160** may be examples of the router eligible end device **240**. A control device that is, for example, externally powered (e.g., a control device that is not battery powered) may be assigned to the role of a router eligible end device.

(67) Referring to FIG. 2A, the network **200** may include the sleepy end device **250**. Sleepy end device **250** may include, or may be similar to, an end device. For example, the sleepy end device **250** may be an end device that is powered by a finite power source (e.g., a battery). The sleepy end device **250** may be aware of its role as a sleepy end device based on, for example, an indication that is stored at the sleepy end device **250**. Communication with the sleepy end device **250** may be performed such that the finite power source is preserved and/or is efficiently consumed. For example, the sleepy end device **250** may periodically disable their respective communication circuits in between message transmissions. The sleepy end device **250** may transmit and/or receive messages via an attached router device **220a**. As shown in FIG. 2A, the sleepy end device **250** may be one of the end devices that is attached to the router device **220a**. Input devices (e.g., the remote control device **170**) and/or load control devices (e.g., the motorized window treatments **150** when battery powered) may be examples of the sleepy end device **250**. In addition, sensors and/or battery power devices may be examples of the sleepy end device **250**.

(68) The leader device **210** may update the roles (e.g., or confirm role updates) of the control devices communicating within the network **200**, for example, based on changes to the network **200**. In an example, a control device may be assigned to a certain role when the control device attaches to the network **200**, and the leader device **210** may update the role of the control device based on changes in network conditions. Changes in network conditions may include: increased message traffic, attachment of other control devices, changes in signal strength, etc. Updates to the assigned role of a control device may be based on the capabilities of the control device. For example, the leader device **210** may update the role of a control device from a router eligible end device to a router device (e.g., as a router eligible end device is an end device that is eligible to perform the role of a router device). The leader device **210** may update the role of an end device (e.g., a router eligible end device) to a router device by assigning a router identifier (ID) to the control device.

(69) The control devices attached to other devices on the network **200** may further operate as parent devices and/or child devices. Leader devices (e.g., the leader device **210**) and router devices (e.g., the router devices **220a-220d**) that are attached to one or more end devices (e.g., the end devices **230a**, **230b**, the router eligible end device **240**, and/or the sleepy end device **250**) may operate as parent devices. End devices (e.g., the end devices **230a**, **230b**, the router eligible end device **240**, and/or the sleepy end device **250**) that are attached to a leader device (e.g., the leader device **210**) or a router device (e.g., one of the router devices **220a-220d**) may operate as child devices. As a parent device, the leader device **210** and the router devices **220a-220d** may each be attached to one or more child devices (e.g., one or more of the end devices **230a**, **230b**, the router eligible end device **240**, and/or the sleepy end device **250**, as described herein). In addition, the leader device **210** and the router devices **220a-220d** may store and/or relay messages that are sent by their respective attached child devices. For example, the leader device **210** and the router devices **220a-220d** may receive messages from their respective child devices and route the received messages to the intended recipient device (e.g., either directly to the intended recipient device, via the respective parent device of the intended recipient device, and/or to a router device or leader device this is on the path to the intended recipient). Similarly, the leader device **210** and the router devices **220a-220d** may receive messages intended for their respective child device and route the message to the appropriate child device. The parent of a respective sleepy end device may schedule communications with the sleepy end device when the communication circuit of the sleepy end device is enabled.

(70) As indicated in FIG. 2A, the relationship (e.g., attachment) between a child device and a respective parent device may be indicated by single solid lines. For example, the router device **220a** may be configured as the parent device of the end device **230a** and the sleepy end device **250**. Similarly, the router device **220b** may be configured as the parent device of the end device **230b**. The router device **220a** may receive messages intended for the end device **230a** and forward the message to the end device **230a**. As the router device **220a** is configured as the parent device of the

end device **230a**, the end device **230a** may transmit messages to the router device **220a**, and the router device **220a** may route the message to the intended recipient. For example, when the end device **230a** intends to transmit a message to the end device **230b**, the end device **230a** may initially transmit the message to the router device **220a**. The router device **220a** may route the message to the router device **220b** (e.g., the parent device of the end device **230b**). For example, the router device **220a** may route the message to router device **220b** via router device **220c** or router device **220d**, and the router device **220b** may then forward the message to the end device **230b**. In addition, as described herein and illustrated in FIG. 2A, the router device **220a** may route the message to the end device **230b** via the router device **220c** (e.g., the auxiliary parent device of the router device **230b**).

(71) Child devices may each be configured to transmit unicast messages to their respective parent device. The messages transmitted by a child device to its respective parent device may include an indication (e.g., a unique identifier) of the intended recipient, and the parent device may route the message accordingly. Referring again to FIG. 2A, the end device **230a** may transmit messages to the router device **220a** (e.g., the parent device of the end device **230a**), and the router device **220a** may route the message based on the intended recipient. For example, if the end device **230a** transmits a message intended for the end device **230b**, the router device **220a** may route the message to the router device **220b** (e.g., the parent device of the router eligible end device **230b**) via the router device **220c** or the router device **220d**. For example, if the router device **220a** routes the message via the router device **220d**, the router device **220d** may forward the message to the router device **220b**, which may forward the message to the end device **230b**. The router device **220a** may identify that the router device **220b** is the parent device that the end device **230b** is attached via a lookup table. As illustrated in FIG. 2A, multiple paths may exist to route messages over the network **200**, and router device may identify the shortest path (e.g., lowest number of hops) to transmit messages to a respective device.

(72) Child devices may each be configured to communicate with one or more auxiliary parent devices (e.g., configured to communicate with more than one parent device). Referring to FIG. 2A, for example, the end device **230b** may be configured to communicate with (e.g., transmit message to and receive messages from) a parent device (e.g., a primary parent device), such as the router device **220b**. The end device **230b** may also be configured to communicate with (e.g., receive messages from) an auxiliary parent device, such as the router device **220c** (e.g., as illustrated by the dashed lines in FIG. 2A). A child device may receive unicast messages from its parent device (e.g., primary parent device). A child device may also receive multicast messages or broadcast messages from its parent device (e.g., primary parent device) and one or more auxiliary parent devices, which may increase the efficiency and reliability of child device receiving the messages. Certain messages may be propagated and broadcast by multiple devices in the network **200**, which may increase the likelihood that a respective child device hears a message. For example, rather than sending multiple transmissions, multicast messages that are substantially similar (e.g., messages that include the same load control instructions that are sent to multiple load control devices) may be broadcasted. Referring again to the load control system **100** of FIG. 1A, an actuation of a button of the remote control device **170** may adjust the intensity of multiple lighting loads (e.g., the lighting load **122** and the floor lamp **142**) and a message may be broadcasted to adjust the respective lighting loads. In addition, the control devices that receive the broadcast transmission may be configured to process and repeat the message in response to receiving the broadcast transmission.

(73) As described herein, the network **200** shown in FIG. 2A may allow for communication between devices in a load control system (e.g., the load control system **100** shown in FIG. 1A). The end devices **230a**, **230b** may include load control devices and/or input devices that communicate with other devices in the load control system. For example, the end device **230a** may communicate with another end device in the load control system via RF communications.

(74) Referring now to FIG. 1A, the remote control device **170** may operate as an end device or a

sleepy end device for communicating messages comprising indications of user input and/or control instructions for controlling another end device (e.g., the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatment **150**, and/or the thermostat **160**). The remote control device **170** may communicate via one or more intermediary parent devices, such as a leader device and/or a router device, for example. The leader device and/or the router device may communicate with one or more other leader devices and/or router devices the network to route the messages to the other end device (e.g., the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatment **150**, and/or the thermostat **160**) for performing load control.

(75) A control device may attach to another control device on a network or network partition (e.g., the network **200** shown in FIG. 2A) to enable the control device to communicate (e.g., transmit and/or receive messages) via the network. A control device may initiate attachment to a network by transmitting a parent request message to discover potential parent devices. A parent request message may be transmitted by a control device to discover and/or attach to a parent device (e.g., leader devices and/or router devices). A control device may multicast a parent request message, for example, to identify leader or router devices that are attached to a network that can act as a parent device of the control device.

(76) Potential parent devices (e.g., the leader device **210** and/or the router devices **220** of the network **200**) that receive a parent request message may respond by transmitting a parent response message. For example, potential parent devices that receive a parent request message may each unicast a parent response message to the end device that transmitted the parent request message. A parent response message may indicate that the leader or router device that transmits the parent response message is available to act as a parent device. Accordingly, a control device that transmits a parent request message may receive a plurality of response to the parent request message and determine a parent device to synchronize with based on the received parent response messages. The control device transmitting the attachment request message may identify the signal strength associated with the response messages and attempt attachment to the parent device having the strongest signal strength for the response message.

(77) FIG. 2B is an example illustration of a network **200a** having a plurality of network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** (e.g., separate network partitions). As illustrated in FIG. 2B, the network partition **201** may include the following parent devices: a leader device **211** and router devices **221a**, **221b**, **221c**, **221d**. In addition, the network **201** may include child devices, such as: end devices **231a**, **231b**; router eligible end device **241**; and sleepy end device **251**. For example, each of the router devices **221a-221d** in the network partition **201** may be assigned a unique router identifier. The network partition **202** may include the following parent devices: a leader device **212** and router devices **222a**, **222b**, **222c**, **222d**. In addition, the network **202** may include child devices, such as: end devices **232a**, **232b**; router eligible end device **242**; and sleepy end device **252**. For example, each of the router devices **222a-222d** in the network partition **202** may be assigned a unique router identifier. The network partition **203** may include a single parent device, leader device **213**, and a single end device, end device **223**.

(78) As illustrated in FIG. 2B, the network partition **203** may include a leader device **213** and an end device **223**. The network partition **203**, however, may fail to include a router device. Rather, the leader device **213** may function as the sole router within the network partition **203**. A leader device that is not connected or synchronized with a router device may be referred to as a singleton device. For example, the leader device **213** may be a singleton device. As illustrated in FIG. 2B, a singleton device may be connected to one or more child devices (e.g., the end device **223**). The network partition **203** may be a singleton partition. As illustrated in FIG. 2B, a singleton partition may include a leader device (e.g., the leader device **213**). In addition, a singleton partition may include one or more end devices (e.g., the end device **223**). However, as illustrated in FIG. 2B, a singleton partition may not include a router device.

(79) The network **200a** may allow for communication between devices in a load control system (e.g., the load control system **100**). In addition, the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** may be formed as a result of certain devices being unable for attach to an already formed network partition. For example, as described herein, a control device may attempt to attach to a network partition by transmitting a parent request message. If, however, the control device fails to receive a response to the parent request message (e.g., because the control device is outside of a communication range of an already formed network partition), the control device may attempt to form its own network partition.

(80) A control device that is unable to attach to a network partition may form another network partition. For example, referring to FIG. 2B, the leader device **213** may have been unable to attach to the network partitions **201**, **202** (e.g., because the leader device **213** was outside of communication range of the network partitions **201**, **202**). Accordingly, the leader device **213** may form the network **203** and the end device **223** may attach to the network partition **203**. Similarly, the leader device **212** may have been unable to attach to the network partitions **201**, **203** (e.g., because the leader device **212** is outside of communication range of the network partitions **201**, **203**) and formed the network partition **202**.

(81) A network partition may be associated with a partition identifier (e.g., a partition ID). The partition identifier may be randomly or pseudo-randomly assigned (e.g., randomly assigned from a range or list of identifiers). For example, a priority of the respective network partition may be based on the partition identifier for the network partition. The partition identifier may be assigned by randomly selecting a number from a range of partition identifier values. Referring now to FIG. 2B, the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** may each be associated with a respective partition identifier. For example, the network partition **202** may be assigned a partition identifier of 1, the network partition **203** may be assigned a partition identifier of 2, and the network partition **201** may be assigned a partition identifier of 3. Although the partition identifiers of the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** are sequential (e.g., in order to provide for a simplified explanation), the assignment of the partition identifiers to the network partition may be sequential, non-sequential, and/or randomized. As described herein, partition identifier may also be an indication of a priority of the respective network partition **201**, **202**, **203**. For example, the partition identifier may also be a priority value of the respective network partition **201**, **202**, **203** (e.g., respective priorities of the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** may be 3, 1, and 2). In addition, a higher priority value may indicate a higher network partition priority (e.g. then network partition **201** may be a higher priority network partition than the network partitions **202**, **203**).

(82) As control devices attach to other control devices in each of the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203**, the effective communication range of each of the network partitions may increase. In addition, control devices that were initially unable to attach to control devices in one or more of the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** (e.g., because the control device was previously outside of the communication ranges of all of the network partitions), may subsequently be able to attach to control devices in one of the network partitions **201**, **202**, **203**. Moreover, communication within a load control system may be better facilitated when a single network partition is formed (e.g., the network **200** having a single network partition as illustrated in FIG. 2A) as compared to when multiple network partitions are formed (e.g., the network **200a** having multiple network partitions **201**, **202**, **203** as illustrated in FIG. 2B). For example, communication within a load control system may be better facilitated when a single network partition is formed because a control device in a network partition may be unable to transmit messages to control devices attached to another network partition (e.g., a control device in a network partition may be unable to communicate with other control devices outside the network partition). Accordingly, if a control device attached to a control device in a first network partition is also within the communication range of a second network partition, the control device may attempt to detach from the control device in the first network partition and attach to a control device in the second network partition. For example, a

control device may detach from the control device in the first network partition and attach to the control device in the second network partition when the priority of the second network partition is higher than the priority of the first network partition.

(83) The router devices in each of the network partitions **201**, **202** may each be associated with a communication range. The communication range of each of the respective router devices may be pre-defined and/or pre-configured. For example, the communication range of each of the respective router devices may be pre-defined and/or pre-configured based on the hardware components of each of the respective router devices. The effective communication range of a respective network or network partition may be based on the communication range of the routers in the respective network (e.g., a summation of the communication range of each of the routers in the respective network). As a result, the communication range of a respective network or network partition may increase as the number of router devices in the respective network increases.

(84) As described herein, the control devices attached to a control device in a lower-priority network partition may attempt to attach to a higher-priority network partition. For example, the control devices attached to a control device in the network partition **202** may attempt to attach to a control device in the network partition **201** (e.g., as the network partition **201** has a priority value of 3 and the network partition **202** has a priority value of 1). The router device **222a** may receive a partition advertisement message from a control device attached to a control device in the network partition **201** (e.g., from the router device **221d**). The advertisement may include an indication of the partition identifier of the network **201** (e.g., 3) may be greater than the partition identifier of the network partition **202** and may indicate that the network partition **201** is a higher-priority network partition than the network **202**. The router device **222a** may determine to attach to a control device in the network partition **201** (e.g., as the network partition **201** has a higher priority).

(85) The router device **222a** may attempt to move to the network partition **201** by transmitting a request to the leader device of the network partition **201** (e.g., the leader device **211**). The request may include a request to move to the network partition **201** as a router device, for example, by requesting to move to the network partition **201** and be assigned a certain router identifier. For example, the router device **222a** may request to move to the network partition **201** and be assigned the router identifier that the router device **222a** is assigned in the network partition **201**. In response, the leader device **211** may reject the request if another router device **212a-212d** attached to the network partition **210** is already assigned the requested router identifier. The leader device **211** may accept the request if none of the router devices **212a-212d** attached to the network partition **201** are assigned the requested router identifier. If the router device **222a** moves to the network partition **201** and assigned the requested router identifier, the child devices of the router device **222a** (e.g., the end device **232a** and the sleepy end device **252**) may automatically move to the network partition **201**. For example, as the child devices communicate with the router device **222a** using the router identifier. If the router device **222a** is assigned the requested identifier in the leader device **211** of the network partition **201** (e.g., the router identifier as assigned in the network partition **202**), the child devices may continue to communicate with router device **222a** using the same router identifier.

(86) FIG. 2C is an illustration of an example network **200c**. As illustrated in FIG. 2C, the network **200c** may include a leader device **215** and router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f**. In the network **200c**, the router devices (e.g., the leader device **215** and router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f**) may periodically transmit advertisement messages that may be used for calculating cost and/or quality of communications in the network **200c**. For example, router device **225c** may send an advertisement message that is received by leader device **215** and leader device **215** may send an advertisement message that is received by router device **225c**. Each router device may measure the received communication quality metric (e.g., RSSI) of the received advertisement message and calculate a link quality at which the advertisement message is received (e.g., link quality in (LQI)).

(87) Each router device (e.g., leader device **215** and router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f**) may send an advertisement message as a broadcast or multicast message. The advertisement messages transmitted by a router device may be received by neighboring router devices that share a single-hop network communication link with the router device transmitting the advertisement messages. A single-hop network communication link may be capable of communicating messages from a router device via a unicast and/or multicast communication directly to another router device. For example, the router devices **225a**, **225c** may be neighboring devices that share a single-hop communication link with the leader device **215**, as the router devices **225a**, **225c** are capable of sending messages directly to and/or receiving messages directly from the leader device **215**. The single-hop network communication link may be a network communication link on which router devices may be capable of directly receiving the advertisement messages above a given link quality (e.g., LQI greater than 0).

(88) After a router device receives a periodic advertisement message from another router device, the router device may calculate the link quality (e.g., LQI) of the network communication link via which the advertisement message is received. The LQI may be calculated as a predefined number that is within a range indicating different link qualities for the network communication link between two devices. For example, the LQI may be indicated by values of 0, 1, 2, or 3. The different indicators of LQI may be assigned based on the RSSI of the received advertisement message and a link margin relative to a predefined receive level. The receive level may be a predefined minimum receive level. The receive level may be established as a predefined RSSI value for communications on the network. For example, the receive level may be defined by a noise floor that is set to an average RSSI value for noise generated on the network over a period of time. In an example using the receive level as a noise floor, a router device (e.g., leader device **215** or router device **225c**) may calculate an LQI of 1 for communications received on a link from a neighboring router device when the RSSI value of one or more advertisement messages (e.g., average RSSI for advertisement messages over a period of time) is at least a link margin of 2 dB above the noise floor. The router device (e.g., leader device **215** or router device **225c**) may calculate a link quality of 2 for communications received on a network communication link with a neighboring router device when the RSSI value of one or more advertisement messages (e.g., average RSSI for advertisement messages over a period of time) is at least a link margin of 10 dB above the noise floor. The router device (e.g., leader device **215** or router device **225c**) may calculate a link quality of 3 for communications received on a network communication link with a neighboring router device when the RSSI value of one or more advertisement messages (e.g., average RSSI for advertisement messages over a period of time) is at least a link margin of 20 dB above the noise floor. A link quality value of zero may indicate that the link quality is unknown or infinite when the RSSI value of one or more advertisement messages (e.g., average RSSI value for advertisement messages over a period of time) is unable to be determined above the noise floor. Though examples are provided for predefined numbers indicating different levels of link quality, and/or different link margins that may be assigned to those levels, other indicators and/or values may be used to define link quality between two routing devices. Additionally, though individual routing devices may be provided as an example (e.g., leader device **215** or router device **225c**), other routing devices may similarly calculate link quality for network communication links between neighboring routing devices.

(89) The LQI of the network communication links measured locally at each control device (e.g., the leader device **215** and the router device **225c**) may be exchanged with the other device on the network communication link. For example, the LQI may be measured locally at each control device and transmitted to the other device via an advertisement message. The LQI that is measured by another router device (e.g., on the other side of the network communication link) and received at a router device may be stored as the link quality out (LQO) for the network communication link. The LQI and/or the LQO may be stored in a local router table at each router device. For example, the

leader device **215** may store the LQI and/or the LQO for the network communication link with each router device in the network **200c** in a router table **229**. Similarly, the router device **225c** may store the LQI and the LQO for communicating with each router device in the network **200c** in a router table **261**.

(90) As described herein, the router tables **229**, **261** may each identify network information for communicating with each router in the network **200c** from the perspective of the devices at which the router tables **229**, **261** are stored. The number of router devices in the network **200c** and/or the router identifiers in use in the network **200c** may be determined from a bitmap **227**, as described herein. The bitmap **227** may be maintained by the leader device **215** and distributed to the other routing devices for locally maintaining their router tables. For example, the router devices **225a**, **225c** may receive the bitmap **227** and update their local router tables. The bitmap **227** may indicate the number of rows in the router tables (e.g., indicating the number of identified router devices in the network) and/or the router identifiers to include in the router tables. The router devices may maintain updated network information for the indicated router identifiers in the router tables. The updated network information in the router tables may include the LQI and/or LQO for the network communication link between the router devices identified in the bitmap **227**. For example, the router **225c** may receive the bitmap **227** from the leader device **215** and update the router table **261** to include router devices in the table **261** that are indicated in the bitmap **277**, or remove router devices in the table **261** that are indicated in the bitmap **277** as failing to be used in the network.

(91) The leader device **215** and router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f** may each use the LQI and LQO in their respective router tables to calculate a link cost for communicating on a network communication link with other router devices. The link quality for the network communication link between the two router devices may be the lesser of the value of the link quality for messages being transmitted out (e.g., LQO) and the value of the link quality for messages being received (e.g., LQI) on a single-hop network communication link between two devices. An LQO or an LQI of zero may indicate that the router device fails to have a direct network communication link with the router device listed in the router table.

(92) A link cost for sending communications between devices on a network communication link may correspond directly to the link quality of communications on the network communication link. The link cost may indicate a relative cost or loss of communications on the network communication link. FIG. 2D is an example table **262** that illustrates example link costs that may correspond to different link qualities. As shown in FIG. 2D, a greater link quality may correspond to a lower link cost for communications on the network communication link between two neighboring devices.

(93) The link cost for each network communication link may be used by a router device to calculate a path cost for communications between the router device and another router device in the network **200c**. The path cost may indicate the relative cost or loss of communications on an entire communication path that may include one or more router devices. The path cost for one communication path may be compared to another to determine a higher quality communication path for sending digital communications that may have a lower relative cost associated with transmission of messages.

(94) The path cost may indicate the overall cost for communicating a message from a starting router device to an ending router device. For example, the path cost may be calculated as the total of the link costs for each hop between the starting router device from which a message may originate and the ending router device at which the message may be received in the network **200c**. Each router device may calculate the path cost to a neighboring device on a single-hop network communication link as being equal to the link cost and store the path cost in the locally-stored router table. For example, the router device **225c** may set the path cost for communications with the leader device **215** equal to the link cost (e.g., lower of LQI and LQO) on the network communication link and store the path cost in the router table **261**. Similarly, the router device **225c**

may set the path cost for communications with the router device **225b** equal to the link cost (e.g., lower of LQI and LQO) on network communication link and store the path cost in the router table. (95) Each router device (e.g., leader device **215** and router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f**) may update the path cost for communicating messages to/from each router device in their respective router table based on the path cost information received from another router device. For example, as the router device **225b** may be unable to directly communicate with the leader device **215**, the router device **225b** may receive path cost information for communicating messages through another router in the network **200c**. The router **225c** may transmit the path cost for communicating messages to/from the leader device **215** (e.g., path cost=2) in a multicast message that is received by other router devices. The multicast message may be an advertisement message, for example. The router device **225b** may receive the path cost for communicating messages between the leader device **215** and the router device **225c** (e.g., path cost=2). To calculate the total path cost for communicating messages between the router device **225b** and the leader device **215** through the router device **225c**, the router device **225b** may add the link cost for communications between the router device **225b** and the router device **225c** (e.g., link cost=1) to the path cost received from the router device **225c** (e.g., path cost=1) to get a total path cost (e.g., path cost=3). The link cost for communications between the router device **225b** and the router device **225c** may be determined from the link quality of the network communication link between the router device **225b** and the router device **225c**, which may be the smaller of the LQI and LQO of the network communication link (e.g., link quality=3).

(96) Each router device may send/broadcast an advertisement message that includes the path cost to one or more other router devices in the network **200c**. The router devices that receive the path cost information from the router device that sent the advertisement message may update their respective path cost information in their local router tables (e.g., by adding their link cost for communications with the router device that sent the advertisement message to the path cost in the received message). Each router device may use the locally-stored path cost information to identify the path through which messages may be communicated. For example, messages transmitted from the router device **225b** to the leader device **215** may be communicated through the router device **225a** or the router device **225c**. The router device **225b** may receive respective advertisement messages from the router device **225a** and the router device **225c** that indicate the path cost for communication of messages between the router device **225a** and the leader device **215** is the same as the path cost for communication of messages between the router device **225c** and the leader device **215** (e.g., path cost=2 on each network communication link). The router device **225b** may add the link cost calculated for communicating messages between the router device **225b** and the router device **225c** (e.g., link cost=1) to the path cost information received in the advertisement message from the router **225c** (e.g., path cost=2) to determine the total path cost for communicating with the leader device **215** through the router device **225c** (e.g., total path cost=3). The router device **225b** may similarly add the link cost calculated for communicating messages between the router **225b** and the router **225a** (e.g., link cost=2) to the path cost information received in the advertisement message from the router **225a** (e.g., path cost=2) to determine the total path cost for communicating with the leader device **215** through the router device **225a** (e.g., total path cost=4). The router device **225b** may update a locally-stored router table with the lowest calculated path cost for communicating with the leader device **215** and/or the identifier of the router device through which messages are to be transmitted (e.g., router **225c**). Each router device may similarly update their respective locally-stored router table with the lowest calculated path cost for communicating with the other router devices in the network **200c**. For example, as shown in FIG. 2E, the leader device **215** and the router device **225c** may each calculate the lowest path cost for communicating to other router devices in the network **200c** and store the path cost in the respective router tables **229**, **261**. The router tables **229**, **261** may also have stored therein the router identifier of the next hop from the respective devices **215**, **225c** through which messages are to be communicated to achieve the

calculated path cost for communications to the destination router device.

(97) Through periodically updating the link quality (e.g., LQI and/or LQO), link cost, and/or path cost, and communicating the path cost to other router devices in periodic advertisement messages, each router device may have up-to-date path cost information for communicating messages to other router devices in the network **200c**. The router device may use the best communication path (e.g., lowest cost path) for communicating messages to another device. This routing mechanism may allow router devices to detect when other router devices have dropped off the network **200c**, or a path cost between router devices has changed, and calculate the next lowest cost path to maintain connectivity to other router devices in the network **200c**.

(98) In an effort to distinguish relatively older data being transmitted in the periodic advertisement messages from relatively newer data transmitted in the periodic advertisement messages, the advertisement messages may be communicated with a sequence number. The leader device, such as leader device **215**, may be responsible for updating the sequence number and distributing the updated sequence number to the other router devices in the network (e.g., router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f** in network **200c**). For example, the leader device **215** may increment the sequence number periodically (e.g., after transmission of one or more advertisement messages) and/or after a router device is added to the network. The sequence number may be updated to allow router devices in the network (e.g., leader device **215** and/or router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f** in network **200c**) to identify updated network information transmitted in advertisement messages. For example, as router devices (e.g., leader device **215** and/or router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f** in network **200c**) may be periodically communicating advertisement messages that include path cost information that indicates the path cost for communicating with other router devices in the network, the sequence number may be updated to identify the updated path cost information.

(99) After the leader device **215** updates the sequence number, the leader device **215** may distribute the sequence number to other router devices in the network. For example, the leader device **215** may use the sequence number in its own advertisement messages. After receiving the updated sequence number, each router device may use the updated sequence number for subsequent advertisement messages transmitted from the router device on the network. Each sequence number transmitted from the leader device **215** to the other router devices may be used in the advertisement messages for the router devices until a subsequent sequence number is distributed by the leader device **215**. For example, the router device **225c** may receive the sequence number directly from the leader device **215** and use the sequence number in subsequent advertisement messages. The router device **225b** may receive the sequence number in the advertisement messages transmitted from the router device **225c** and use the sequence number in subsequent advertisement messages transmitted from the router device **225b**. The router devices may each use the current sequence number until an updated sequence number is received that is originated at and distributed from the leader device **215**. Each router device may update the locally-stored network information in the router table when the router device receives an advertisement message from a non-leader router device (e.g., router devices **225a**, **225b**, **225c**, **225d**, **225e**, **225f**) that has an updated sequence number. If a router device receives an advertisement message that has the same sequence number as a previously received advertisement message, and/or previously received from the same non-leader router device, the router device may fail to process the advertisement message. If a router device fails to receive an updated sequence number within a predefined period of time (e.g., minutes, seconds, etc.), the router may assume the leader device **215** is unavailable for communications (e.g., offline, powered off, dropped from the network, changed roles, or is otherwise unable to communicate with the router device) and attempt to form another network or network partition having another leader device **215**.

(100) As described herein, the load control system (e.g., load control system **100**) may be configured to enable transmission of messages between control devices via a wireless

communication network (e.g., network **200**, **200a**). The control devices communicating on the wireless communication network may perform communications on overlapping communication channels (e.g., frequency channels) within the same space. For example, a building may have multiple floors, and each floor may have a system controller configured to communicate with various control devices. The communications may be sent on overlapping frequency channels. In addition to the devices in the load control system, there may be other devices (e.g., other mobile devices, computers, appliances, and/or other devices in the space) using the same frequency channels. There may be a relatively large amount of RF traffic on the frequency channels, increasing the amount of radio frequency interference (RFI) on the frequency channels. The radio frequency interference may cause the devices in the load control system to drop packets transmitted on the network, thereby decreasing reliability and increasing latency on the network.

(101) The control devices in the load control system may perform a modified carrier sense multiple access (CSMA) technique to increase reliability of communications on the network. The CSMA technique may reduce the chance of collisions between messages communicated on a network. For example, the control devices in the load control system that use the CSMA technique may employ a listen before talk (LBT) tactic when transmitting messages. Using the LBT tactic, a control device may measure a signal strength magnitude (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude) of RF traffic (e.g., RF energy) on a given frequency channel before sending a message. For example, the control device may measure the present signal strength magnitude of the frequency channel by determining a received signal strength indicator (RSSI) value of the RF traffic on the frequency channel. A high value for the signal strength magnitude may indicate that the frequency channel is relatively open thus allowing for increased reliability for messages transmitted on the network (e.g., the frequency channel is quiet and/or is not being used by other devices). A low value for the signal strength magnitude may indicate that the frequency channel is relatively congested and may cause decreased reliability for messages transmitted on the network (e.g., the frequency channel is noisy and/or is being used by other devices).

(102) The control device may measure the signal strength value of the RF traffic on the frequency channel and may compare the measured signal strength value to a transmission threshold (e.g., a CSMA threshold). If the measured signal strength magnitude is less than the transmission threshold, the control device may transmit the message. If the measured signal strength magnitude is greater than, or equal to, the threshold value, the control device may delay the transmission of the message. For example, the control device may wait for a predetermined period of time after performing the measurement of the signal strength magnitude and/or comparing the measurement to the threshold. After the predetermined period of time expires, the control device may perform another measurement of the signal strength magnitude and/or attempt to transmit the message again.

(103) When control devices perform the CSMA technique, the reliability of transmissions of messages between the control devices in the load control system may increase. However, the increase in reliability may come at the expense of latency. For example, if the number of devices in the load control system is sufficiently large, control devices may occupy the frequency channel for extended periods of time even if the control devices in the load control system are performing the CSMA technique. For example, a given control device in the load control system may perform measurements of the signal strength magnitude multiple times before transmitting a message, thus increasing latency.

(104) The control devices in the load control system may employ an adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX (e.g., an adaptive CSMA threshold) when using the CSMA technique to have a lower latency, while still maintaining increased reliability. Prior to transmitting a message, a control device may analyze the communication channel (e.g., frequency channel) using the adaptive transmission threshold Mix to determine if the message should be transmitted. The control device may measure a metric of the frequency channel, such as the signal strength magnitude (e.g.,

a received signal strength indicator) of the RF traffic on a frequency channel and compare the measurement to the adaptive transmission threshold Mix. The control device may transmit the message when the measured signal strength magnitude is below the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. The control device may increase or decrease the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to increase reliability of communications on the network, while allowing for a balanced latency for the tradeoff of increased reliability. When the control device tries to transmit a given message for the first time, the control device may set the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to a relatively low level. If the measured signal strength magnitude is above the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control device may increase the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to increase the likelihood that the next measurement of the of the signal strength magnitude will be below the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX and the control device will transmit the message. The control device may continue to increase the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX until the message is transmitted. By first analyzing the frequency channel the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at the low level and then gradually increasing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control device first has the chance to transmit the message when the frequency channel is quietest while gradually increasing the likelihood of transmitting the message at the same time as another control device.

(105) FIG. 3 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure **300** for performing a CSMA technique using an adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. The procedure **300** may be performed by a control circuit of a control device in a load control system. For example, the control device may be one of the control devices in the load control system **100** (e.g., the load control devices, the input devices, the mobile device **190**, and/or the system controller **110**) and/or one of the control devices capable of performing communications in a network similar to the networks **200**, **200a**. There may be a relatively large amount of radio frequency (RF) traffic in the network due to the messages being transmitted between the control devices in the load control system. As the amount of RF traffic in the network increases, the incidence of collisions between transmissions may increase, which may result in communication errors (e.g., collisions of messages). The control device in the load control system may perform the procedure **300** based on a triggering event. For example, the control device may perform the procedure **300**, or portions thereof, after queueing of a message to be transmitted, or after receipt of a message for which a response message is to be transmitted.

(106) The procedure **300** may be used to attempt to reduce the amount of RF traffic in the network while balancing latency for the transmission of messages. For example, a control device performing the procedure **300** may perform the CSMA technique when transmitting a message. Performing the procedure **300** may result in the control device having an increased likelihood of transmitting a message after each instance of an LBT failure, which may occur when the measured signal strength magnitude fails to be equal to or lower than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. The control device may become progressively more likely to transmit the message after each instance of LBT failure.

(107) The procedure **300** may begin at **302**. At **303**, the control circuit of the control device may initialize the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to a minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN. The minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device. The minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be approximately -90 dBm, and the control device may set the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to have a value of -90 dBm.

(108) At **304**, the control circuit of the control device may measure a metric of the frequency channel (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude of the RF traffic on the frequency channel. For example, the control device may measure the signal strength magnitude at **304** by measuring the RSSI value of RF traffic on the frequency channel. For example, the frequency channel may be a frequency channel used by the control devices to send messages to and/or receive messages from

one or more other control devices in the network.

(109) At **306**, the control circuit of the control device may compare the measured RSSI value to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. The control device may determine whether the measured RSSI value is greater than, equal to, or less than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. If the measured RSSI value is less than (e.g., less than or equal to) the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may transmit the message at **308** via the communication circuit and the procedure **300** may end at **310**. If the measured RSSI value is greater than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX by an increment ΔTH at **312**. For example, the increment ΔTH may be between approximately 5-10 dBm. The increment ΔTH may be preconfigured in the control device (e.g., stored therein) and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the increment ΔTH may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device. The increment ΔTH may be a fixed amount, a predefined amount, or a variable amount. The value of the increment ΔTH may be determined as a function of one or more predefined parameters. For example, the one or more parameters may include a number of previous attempts of transmitting the message, the communication quality metric of the frequency channel, a difference between the communication quality metric of the frequency channel and the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, an amount of near-channel interference (e.g., a noise level on a communication channel adjacent to the frequency channel), a link quality associated with the frequency channel, a path loss associated with the frequency channel, and/or the like. Incrementing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may increase the likelihood that the control device may transmit the message without additional delay. After increasing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may measure the RSSI value of the frequency channel at **304** for comparison with the incremented transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **306**. The control device may continue to increment the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX until the measured RSSI value is less than or equal to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX and/or the message is transmitted. For example, the control device may measure the metric of the frequency channel, compare the metric to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, and/or increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX after each expiration of a predefined interval before transmitting the message. The control device may reset the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX after transmission of the message.

(110) As the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may continue to be increased, a maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX may be set to limit the delay or latency of a transmission of a message. FIG. 4 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure **400** for performing a CSMA technique using an adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX and a maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX. The procedure **400** may be performed by a control device in a load control system. For example, the control device may be one of the control devices in the load control system **100** (e.g., the load control devices, the input devices, the mobile device **190**, and/or the system controller **110**) and/or one of the control devices capable of performing communications in a network similar to the networks **200**, **200a**. There may be a relatively large amount of radio frequency (RF) traffic in the network due to the messages being transmitted between the control devices in the load control system. As the amount of RF traffic in the network increases, the incidence of collisions between transmissions may increase, which may result in communication errors (e.g., collisions of messages). The control device in the load control system may perform the procedure **400** based on a triggering event. For example, the control device may perform the procedure **400**, or portions thereof, after queueing of a message to be transmitted, or after receipt of a message for which a response message is to be transmitted.

(111) The procedure **400** may be used to attempt to reduce the amount of RF traffic in the network while balancing latency for the transmission of messages. For example, a control device performing the procedure **400** may perform the CSMA technique when transmitting a message.

Performing the procedure **400** may result in the control device having an increased likelihood of transmitting a message after each instance of an LBT failure. The control device may become progressively more likely to transmit the message after each instance of LBT failure.

(112) The procedure **400** may begin at **402**. At **404**, the control circuit of the control device in the load control system may initialize the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to a minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN. The minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device. The minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be approximately -90 dBm, and the control device may set the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to have a value of -90 dBm.

(113) At **406**, the control circuit of the control device may measure a metric of the frequency channel (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude of the RF traffic on the frequency channel). For example, the control device may measure the signal strength magnitude at **406** by measuring the RSSI value of RF traffic on the frequency channel. The frequency channel may be a frequency channel used by the control device to send messages to and/or receive messages from one or more other control devices in the network.

(114) At **408**, the control circuit of the control device may compare the measured RSSI value to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. The control device may determine whether the measured RSSI value is greater than, equal to, or less than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. If the measured RSSI value is less than (e.g., less than or equal to) the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control device may transmit the message at **414** and the procedure **400** may end at **416**. If the measured RSSI value is greater than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may compare the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX at **410**. For example, the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX may be approximately -45 dBm. If the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX is greater than or equal to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX at **410**, the control circuit of the control device may transmit the message at **414** via the communication circuit and the procedure **400** may end at **416**. The maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX may be set to limit the delay or latency of a transmission of a message.

(115) If the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX is not greater than or equal to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX at **410**, the control circuit of the control device may increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX by an increment ΔTH at **412**. For example, the increment ΔTH may be between approximately 5-10 dBm. The increment ΔTH may be preconfigured in the control device (e.g., stored therein) and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the increment ΔTH may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device. The increment ΔTH may be a fixed amount, a predefined amount, or a variable amount. The value of the increment ΔTH may be determined as a function of one or more predefined parameters. For example, the one or more parameters may include a number of previous attempts of transmitting the message, the communication quality metric of the frequency channel, a difference between the communication quality metric of the frequency channel and the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, an amount of near-channel interference (e.g., a noise level on a communication channel adjacent to the frequency channel), a link quality associated with the frequency channel, a path loss associated with the frequency channel, and/or the like. Incrementing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may increase the likelihood that the control device may transmit the message. After increasing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control device may measure the RSSI value of the frequency channel at **406** for comparison with the incremented transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **408**. The control device may continue to increment the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX until the measured RSSI value is less than or equal to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX and/or the message is transmitted. For example, the

control device may measure the metric of the frequency channel, compare the metric to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, and/or increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX after each expiration of a predefined interval before transmitting the message or the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX has been reached. The control device may reset the transmission threshold after transmission of the message.

(116) The adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may be adjusted a number of times to prevent the number of transmission attempts from exceeding a maximum number as the control device attempts to increase the likelihood of transmission of the message on the frequency channel. FIG. 5 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure **500** for performing a CSMA technique using an adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX and a counter. The procedure **500** may be performed by a control device in a load control system. For example, the control device may be one of the control devices in the load control system **100** (e.g., the load control devices, the input devices, the mobile device **190**, and/or the system controller **110**) and/or one of the control devices capable of performing communications in the networks **200**, **200a**. There may be a relatively large amount of radio frequency (RF) traffic in the network due to the messages being transmitted between the control devices in the load control system. As the amount of RF traffic in the network increases, the incidence of collisions between transmissions may increase, which may result in communication errors (e.g., collisions of messages). The control device in the load control system may perform the procedure **500** based on a triggering event. For example, the control device may perform the procedure **500**, or portions thereof, after queueing of a message to be transmitted, or after receipt of a message for which a response message is to be transmitted.

(117) The procedure **500** may be used to reduce the amount of RF traffic in the network while balancing latency for the transmission of messages. For example, a control device in the load control system performing the procedure **500** may perform the CSMA technique when transmitting a message. Performing the procedure **500** may result in the control device having an increased likelihood of transmitting a message after each instance of an LBT failure. The control device may become progressively more likely to transmit the message after each instance of LBT failure. Implementing a counter may ensure that the message is transmitted after a certain number of LBT failures, regardless of RF traffic or interference.

(118) The procedure **500** may begin at **502**. At **504**, the control circuit of the control device in the load control system may initialize a counter N to a minimum value (e.g., zero). The minimum value may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the minimum value at which the counter N is initialized may be received by the control device in the load control system from the system controller or another remote computing device.

(119) At **505**, the control circuit of the control device in the load control system may initialize the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to a minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN. The minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device. The minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be approximately -90 dBm, and the control device may set the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to have a value of -90 dBm.

(120) At **506**, the control circuit of the control device may measure a metric of the frequency channel (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude of the RF traffic on the frequency channel). For example, the control device may measure the signal strength magnitude at **506** by measuring the RSSI value of RF traffic on the frequency channel. For example, the frequency channel may be a frequency channel used by the control devices to send messages to and/or receive message from one or more other control devices in the network.

(121) At **508**, the control circuit of the control device may compare the measured RSSI value to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. The transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may be preconfigured

in the device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may be received by the control device in the load control system from the system controller or another remote computing device. The control device may determine whether the measured RSSI value is greater than, equal to, or less than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. If the measured RSSI value is less than (e.g., less than or equal to) the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may transmit the message at **516** via the communication circuit and the procedure **500** may end at **518**. If the measured RSSI value is greater than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may compare the counter N to a maximum counter value N.sub.MAX at **510**. For example, the maximum counter value N.sub.MAX may be set to 10. If the counter N is greater than or equal to the maximum counter value N.sub.MAX at **510**, the control circuit of the control device may transmit the message at **516** via the communication circuit and the procedure **500** may end at **518**. The maximum counter value N.sub.MAX may prevent the number of transmission attempts from exceeding a defined value. The maximum counter value N.sub.MAX may be preconfigured in the device and/or indicated in a message received by the device. For example, the maximum counter value N.sub.MAX may be received by the control device in the load control system from the system controller or another remote computing device.

(122) If the counter N is less than or equal to the maximum counter value N.sub.MAX, the control circuit of the control device may increment the counter N by a predefined value (e.g., one) at **512**. Delaying the transmission of the message while the counter N is being incremented may increase the likelihood that the control device may successfully transmit the message. The control circuit of the control device may increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX by an increment ΔTH at **514**. For example, the increment ΔTH may be between approximately 5-10 dBm. The increment ΔTH may be preconfigured in the control device (e.g., stored therein) and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the increment ΔTH may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device. The increment ΔTH may be a fixed amount, a predefined amount, or a variable amount. The value of the increment ΔTH may be determined as a function of one or more predefined parameters. For example, the one or more parameters may include a number of previous attempts of transmitting the message, the communication quality metric of the frequency channel, a difference between the communication quality metric of the frequency channel and the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, an amount of near-channel interference (e.g., a noise level on a communication channel adjacent to the frequency channel), a link quality associated with the frequency channel, a path loss associated with the frequency channel, and/or the like. Incrementing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may increase the likelihood that the control device may transmit the message. After increasing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control circuit of the control device may measure the RSSI value of the frequency channel at **506** for comparison with the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **508**. The control circuit of the control device may continue to increment the counter N at **512** and increment the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **514** until the counter N is equal to or greater than the maximum counter value N.sub.MAX at **510** or the measured RSSI value of the frequency channel is less than or equal to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **508**. Thus, the control device may attempt to transmit the message when the RSSI value of the frequency channel is less than or equal to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, or a defined number of attempts have been made for transmitting the message. For example, the control device may measure the metric of the frequency channel, compare the metric to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, and/or increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX after each expiration of a predefined interval before transmitting the message, the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX is reached, or a defined number of attempts have been made for transmitting the message. The control device may reset the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX and/or the counter N after transmission of the message.

(123) As the background noise in different locations in the space in which the network is deployed

may vary, the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may be based on a background signal strength magnitude (e.g., a background RSSI value) if the frequency channel measured at a certain time and/or in a certain location at which the control device is installed in the space. Basing the adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX on the background signal strength magnitude may ensure that control devices located in spaces with differing amounts of RF traffic maintain similar likelihoods of communicating messages. FIG. 6 is a flowchart depicting an example procedure **600** for determining the background signal strength magnitude (e.g., the background RSSI value) of a frequency channel. The procedure **600** may be performed by a control device in a load control system. For example, the control device may be one of the devices in the load control system **100** (e.g., the load control devices, the input devices, the mobile device **190**, and/or the system controller **110**) and/or one of the control devices capable of performing communications in a network similar to the networks **200**, **200a**. There may be a relatively large amount of radio frequency (RF) traffic in the network due to the messages being transmitted between the control devices in the load control system. As the amount of RF traffic in the network increases, the incidence of collisions between transmissions may increase, which may result in communication errors (e.g., collisions of messages). The control device in the load control system may perform the procedure **600** based on a triggering event. For example, the control device may perform the procedure **600**, or portions thereof, periodically.

(124) The procedure **600** may be used to ensure that control devices located in spaces with differing amounts of RF traffic maintain similar likelihoods of transmitting messages. For example, a control device performing the procedure **600** may dynamically adjust a value for the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX based on the background signal strength magnitude in the space. The control device may adjust the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX based on, for example, a measured background RSSI value. Dynamically adjusting the value for the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may increase the likelihood that a message will be transmitted by controlling for the average amount of RF traffic in the space in which the control device is located. The control device in a space with more RF traffic may have a higher value for the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX than a control device in a space with less RF traffic. For example, the control device may be located near a noise source, such as a wireless access point (WAP), a microwave oven, a security badge reader, a motor, and/or other radio-frequency noise-generating device.

(125) The procedure **600** may begin at **602**. At **604**, the control circuit of the control device in the load control system may measure a metric of the frequency channel (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude of the RF traffic on the frequency channel). For example, the control device may measure the signal strength magnitude at **604** by measuring the RSSI value of RF traffic on the frequency channel. At **606**, the control circuit of the control device may update a value of the background signal strength (e.g., the background RSSI value) of the frequency channel. For example, the control device may determine the background RSSI value by continuously or periodically measuring the RSSI value of the frequency channel. The background RSSI value may be calculated and updated at **606** using a peak value, time-weighted average, a mean, a median, and/or another form of measurement of measured background signal strength magnitudes (e.g., measured RSSI values) over a period of time. The background RSSI value may be updated continuously or periodically (e.g., as the RSSI value of the frequency channel is measured).

(126) At **608**, the control circuit of the control device may update the value of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX (e.g., the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX) based on the background RSSI value. For example, the control device may set the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to be equal to the background RSSI value plus an offset value. The offset value may be, for example, 10 dBm. For example, if the background RSSI value is determined to be -90 dBm, the control device may set the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to be -80 dBm. At **610**, the procedure **600** may exit. After executing the procedure **600** to update the

minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold TH.sub.MAX, the control device may start with the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX set to the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN that is based on the background signal strength magnitude when subsequently attempting to transmit a message using the procedure **300** shown in FIG. **3**, the procedure **400** shown in FIG. **4**, and/or the procedure **500** shown in FIG. **5**.

(127) FIG. **7** is a flowchart depicting an example procedure **700** for performing a CSMA technique with an adaptive transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, where a minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or a maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may be based on a priority context of a message. The method **700** may be performed by a control circuit of a control device in a load control system. For example, the control device may be one or more of the control devices in the load control system **100** (e.g., the load control devices, the input devices, the mobile device **190**, and/or the system controller **110**) and/or one of the control devices capable of communicating in a network similar to the networks **200**, **200a**. There may be a relatively large amount of radio frequency (RF) traffic in the network due to the messages being transmitted between the control devices in the load control system. As the amount of RF traffic in the network increases, the incidence of collisions between transmissions may increase, which may result in communication errors (e.g., collisions of messages). The control device in the load control system may perform the procedure **700** based on a triggering event. For example, the control device may perform the procedure **700**, or portions thereof, after queueing of a message to be transmitted, or after receipt of a message for which a response message is to be transmitted.

(128) The procedure **700** may be used to attempt to reduce the amount of RF traffic in the network while balancing latency for the transmission of messages. The control device may use different values for the transmission threshold Mix (e.g., different values of the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX of the CSMA threshold TH.sub.TX) based on the priority context of the message. For example, the control device may use a higher value for the transmission threshold Mix (e.g., one or both of the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX) when the messages have a higher-priority context and a lower value for the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX (e.g., one or both of the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX) when the messages have a lower-priority context. Using a higher value for the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX for messages with a higher-priority context may increase the chance that the messages will be transmitted at a given instance (e.g., despite increased RF traffic). Transmission of messages with a lower-priority context may be further delayed to allow for other messages to have a higher success rate.

(129) The procedure **700** may begin at **702**. At **704**, the control circuit of the control device may determine a priority context of a message to be transmitted. For example, the priority context may be determined to be a higher-priority context for latency critical messages or a lower-priority context for latency non-critical messages. A latency-critical message may be a message for which latency above a predefined latency threshold is unacceptable and/or mitigated with a higher transmission threshold TH.sub.TX (e.g., one or both of the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX). A latency non-critical message may be a message for which latency above the predefined latency threshold is acceptable and/or permitted with the use of a lower transmission threshold TH.sub.TX (e.g., one or both of the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX).

(130) For example, a latency-critical message may be a message where a latency greater than a latency threshold (e.g., 350-375 milliseconds) is unacceptable and/or undesirable. The latency of a message may be measured as a time between a triggering event (e.g., a press of a button, an activation of a sensor device, an activation of a scene, and/or the like) and a corresponding change in a state of the control device. The control device may be, for example, a lighting control device, a thermostat, a speaker, a motorized window shade, and/or the like. The change in the state of the

control device may include a change in the intensity or color temperature of light output by the lighting control device, a temperature change, a volume change, and/or a speed or height level of the motorized window treatment. The latency may include one or more hops between devices in the network. A latency greater than the latency threshold may be noticeable to a user of the control device. For example, a delay of greater than 350-375 milliseconds from the time a user triggers a message configured to perform control of an electrical load (e.g., button press, activation of a sensor device, activation of a scene) to the time the electrical load is controlled may be noticeable to the user and, therefore, undesirable in the load control system. A latency non-critical message may be a message in the load control system that may allow for greater latency without causing an undesirable result in the load control system or without causing noticeable delay to the user in the control of the electrical loads in the load control system (e.g., system status messages, heartbeat messages, and/or sensor measurements). For example, a delay of greater than 350-375 milliseconds for a latency non-critical message may not be noticeable to the user.

(131) The control circuit of the control device may determine the priority context based on a device type of the control device from which the message is being transmitted. For example, the control device may be classified as a latency-critical device or a latency non-critical device by having an indication stored thereon in memory. The device type may include, for example, a load control device type (e.g., the lighting control device **120**, the plug-in load control device **140**, the motorized window treatments **150**, the thermostat **160**, controllable receptacles, the speaker **146**, and/or other types of control-target devices), an input device type (e.g., the remote control device **170**, the sensor device **141**, and/or other types of input devices), a system controller (e.g., the system controller **110**), a mobile device (e.g., the mobile device **190**), etc. The device type may indicate a form of communication transmitted from the control device. Each control device type may be associated with a desirable latency. For example, an input device may be associated with a lower desirable latency than a load control device.

(132) The control circuit of the control device may determine the device type based on information stored in a memory of the device. A latency-critical device may be a control device from which input may be received from the user. For example, remote control devices (e.g., keypad devices) and/or dimmer switches may be classified as latency-critical devices. These input devices may be categorized as latency critical devices because latency above the latency threshold may cause noticeable delay in performing load control in response to the user input. Occupancy sensors may be classified as latency-critical devices. Occupancy sensors may be categorized as latency critical devices because latency above the latency threshold may cause noticeable delay in performing load control (e.g., turning lighting loads on) in response to the user entering a load control environment. Other input devices may be classified as latency non-critical devices, having an indicator stored in memory for the control device to determine the priority context at **704**. For example, daylight sensors, temperature sensors, humidity sensors, and/or other sensor devices may be classified as latency non-critical devices. These input devices may be categorized as latency non-critical devices because the input devices are sensor devices that are taking incremental measurements that may fluctuate by less than a threshold amount of change over the period of time of the latency threshold, which may fail to cause a noticeable delay in performing load control in response to measurements performed by the sensor devices. In addition, the incremental changes in the values detected by the sensor devices may create incremental changes in the light level output (e.g., lighting intensity) by the control device which may not be noticeable to the user. Further, since the user may not be aware that the sensor devices are taking the measurements, a delay between a measurement and a corresponding change in light level may not be noticeable to the user. Input devices may be classified as latency-critical devices. Load control devices may be classified as latency non-critical devices.

(133) The control circuit of the control device may determine the priority context based on a type and/or content of the message. For example, the message may be classified as a latency-critical

message or a latency non-critical message based on the type of message and/or content being transmitted in the message. Messages that include control instructions for controlling an electrical load may be classified as latency-critical messages. Messages configured to cause greater than a threshold amount of change in a level of an electrical load (e.g., lighting level of a lighting load) may be classified as latency-critical messages. Messages configured to cause greater than a threshold amount of change in lighting intensity and/or color (e.g., color temperature) of a lighting load may be classified as latency-critical messages. For example, toggle messages (e.g., on/off toggle) may be classified as latency-critical messages. Messages configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in the state of the electrical load may be classified as latency non-critical messages. Messages configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in lighting intensity and/or color (e.g., color temperature) of the lighting load may be classified as latency non-critical messages. Messages comprising status information indicating a state of an electrical load or the load control environment, such as feedback messages, heartbeat messages, or other messages comprising system state information may be classified as latency non-critical messages. The messages configured to cause greater than the threshold amount of change in the level of the electrical load may be classified as latency-critical messages because such a command may cause an amount of change that is noticeable or more noticeable to the user than messages configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in the level of the electrical load.

(134) Messages comprising sensor information that is configured to cause greater than the threshold amount of change in the level of the electrical load may be latency-critical messages, while messages comprising sensor information that is configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in the level of the electrical load may be latency non-critical messages. For example, messages indicating an occupancy/vacancy event detected in the space may be classified as a latency-critical message, as occupancy or vacancy condition in the space may trigger a lighting load to be toggled (e.g., turned on and/or off). Messages including sensor information indicating a relative change in lighting intensity or temperature that are transmitted by a daylight sensor or temperature sensor may be classified as latency non-critical messages, as the relative measurement values in the space may be status information indicating a status of the load control environment and/or be configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in the level of the electrical load.

(135) The control circuit of the control device may determine the priority context based on a transmission type of the message. For example, the transmission type may be unicast, multicast, or broadcast. A unicast message may be classified as a latency-critical message, while a broadcast or multicast message may be classified as a latency non-critical message. The multicast or broadcast message may be classified as a latency critical message to allow multiple control devices to be similarly controlled upon receipt of the multicast message, and the unicast message may be classified as a latency non-critical message as a single control device going unchanged may be unnoticeable to a user. Further, the multicast or broadcast message may be used to transmit latency-critical message types, while the unicast message may be used to transmit latency non-critical message types. In another example, the multicast or broadcast message may be classified as a latency non-critical message, as the multicast or broadcast message may be capable of being received by multiple control devices and forwarded to other control devices in the load control system. The unicast messages may be classified as latency-critical, as it may be configured to be received by a single control device for processing. Repeat messages may be classified as a latency non-critical message, while an initial message in a series of messages being transmitted may be classified as a latency critical message.

(136) The control circuit of the control device may determine the priority context based on a network role associated with the message and/or the control device. For example, messages transmitted by a router device on the network may be classified as latency critical messages, while messages transmitted by end devices may be classified as latency non-critical messages. The

priority context of the messages transmitted by the control device may change as the role of the control device changes on the network.

(137) The control circuit of the control device may determine the priority context based on a quality of the network communication link on which messages are being transmitted to/from the control device. Messages to be transmitted on relatively lower-quality network communication links may be classified as latency-critical messages, while messages to be transmitted on relatively higher-quality network communication links may be classified as latency non-critical messages. The strength of a network communication link may be determined based on a link quality, a link cost, a link margin above a noise floor, and/or another communication quality metric. The control circuit may have stored thereon a quality threshold for establishing the relative level of quality for identifying the quality of the network communication links on which messages being transmitted are classified as latency-critical messages or latency non-critical messages. The messages to be transmitted on a relatively lower-quality network communication link may be classified as latency-critical and given a higher-priority context to give the messages a greater chance of success upon initial transmission, while messages to be transmitted on a relatively higher-quality network communication link may be classified as latency non-critical and given a lower-priority context, as these messages may already have a relatively high chance of success upon initial transmission.

(138) The transmission threshold Mix (e.g., one or both of the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX) maybe adjusted according to the determined priority context. At **705**, the control circuit of the control device may determine values for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX based on the determined priority context. For example, if the message is a latency-critical message and/or if the control device type is associated with a relatively lower desirable latency, the control circuit of the control device may select relatively higher values for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX. If the message is a latency non-critical message and/or if the device type is associated with a relatively higher desirable latency, the control circuit of the control device may select relatively lower values for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX.

(139) The control circuit of the control device may determine the value for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX by selecting values from among two or more potential values for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. For example, there may be two or more potential minimum threshold values TH.sub.MIN of the transmission threshold Mix that are associated with latency-critical messages and/or control devices. For example, there may be a first latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN that is higher than a second latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN. The first latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and the second latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may each be higher than the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN for latency-non-critical messages and/or control devices. The first latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and the second latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may each be below a predefined threshold. This may allow the latency-critical minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN to be set to a relatively higher value for latency-critical messages and/or control devices, but be set to a higher or lower threshold depending on network conditions or devices on the network. The potential values for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. The maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX for each of the messages transmitted by the control devices (e.g., latency-critical and latency non-critical) may be the same. The increased minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN for the latency-critical messages and/or control devices may be set to a higher value to reduce latency in the initial latency-critical messages.

(140) For example, the control device may be an input device (e.g., a control-source device) and/or the message may be a latency-critical message. The control device may select a relatively higher value for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX. For example, the control device may determine the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN to be -70 dBm and the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX to be -25 dBm. In another example, the control device may be a load control device and/or the message may be a latency non-critical message. The control device may select a relatively lower value for the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN and/or maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX. For example, the control device may determine the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN to be -90 dBm and the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX to be -45 dBm.

(141) At **706**, the control circuit of the control device may set an initial value for the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. For example, the control device may set the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN determined at **705** (e.g., based on the determined priority context). In addition, the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. For example, the minimum threshold value TH.sub.MIN may be received by the control device from the system controller or another remote computing device.

(142) At **708**, the control circuit of the control device may measure a metric of the network communication link (e.g., a present signal strength magnitude of the RF traffic on the network communication link). For example, the control device may measure the signal strength magnitude at **708** by measuring the RSSI value of RF traffic on one or more frequencies of the network communication link. For example, the network communication link may comprise a communication channel made up of one or more frequencies used by the control device to send messages to and/or receive messages from one or more other control devices in the network. The control device may compare the measured RSSI value to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **710**. The control device may determine whether the measured RSSI value is greater than, equal to, or less than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX. If the measured RSSI value is less than (e.g., less than or equal to) the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control device may transmit the message at **716** and the procedure **700** may end at **718**. If the measured RSSI value is greater than the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, the control device may compare the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX. If the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX is greater than or equal to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX, the control device may transmit the message at **716** and the procedure **700** may end at **718**.

(143) If the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX is not greater than or equal to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX at **712**, the control device may increase the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX by an increment ΔTH at **714**. For example, the increment ΔTH may be between approximately 5-dBm. The increment ΔTH may be preconfigured in the control device and/or indicated in a message received by the control device. The increment ΔTH may be a fixed amount, a predefined amount, or a variable amount. The increment ΔTH may be determined based on the priority context. For example, there may be a latency-critical increment ΔTH that is higher than a latency non-critical increment ΔTH . The value of the increment ΔTH may be determined as a function of one or more predefined parameters. For example, the one or more parameters may include a number of previous attempts of transmitting the message, the communication quality metric of the frequency channel, a difference between the communication quality metric of the frequency channel and the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX, an amount of near-channel interference (e.g., a noise level on a communication channel adjacent to the frequency channel), a link quality associated with the frequency channel, a path loss associated with the frequency channel, and/or the like. Incrementing the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX may increase the likelihood that the control device may transmit the message. The control device may measure the RSSI value of the frequency channel at **708** for comparison with the incremented transmission

threshold Mix at **710**. The control device may continue to increment the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX until the measure RSSI value is less than or equal to the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX at **710** or the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX is greater than or equal to the maximum threshold value TH.sub.MAX at **712**, after which the control device may transmit the message at **716** and the procedure **700** may end. The control device may reset the transmission threshold TH.sub.TX after transmission of the message.

(144) Although features and elements are described herein in particular combinations, each feature or element can be used alone or in any combination with the other features and elements. The methods described herein may be implemented in a computer program, software, instructions, or firmware stored on one or more non-transitory computer-readable media or other machine-readable media for execution by a computer or machine, or portion thereof. For example, the computer-readable or machine-readable media may be executed by a control circuit, such as a processor. Examples of computer-readable media or machine-readable media include electronic signals (transmitted over wired or wireless connections) and computer-readable storage media. Examples of computer-readable storage media include, but are not limited to, a read only memory (ROM), a random access memory (RAM), removable disks, and optical media such as CD-ROM disks, and digital versatile disks (DVDs). The control circuit may access the computer program, software, instructions, or firmware stored on the computer-readable media or machine-readable media for being executed to cause the control circuit to operate as described herein, or to operate one or more devices as described herein.

Claims

1. A device comprising: a communication circuit configured to wirelessly transmit messages on a communication channel; and a control circuit configured to: set a transmission threshold to a first value; measure a first signal strength magnitude of the communication channel; compare the first signal strength magnitude to the transmission threshold; on a condition that the first signal strength magnitude is less than the transmission threshold, transmit a message via the communication circuit on the communication channel; on a condition that the first signal strength magnitude is not less than the transmission threshold, increase the transmission threshold by an increment from the first value to a second value to which a second signal strength magnitude of the communication channel will be subsequently compared to determine whether to transmit the message via the communication circuit on the communication channel; determine that the signal strength magnitude of the communication channel has been measured at least a threshold amount of times; and transmit the message via the communication circuit on the communication channel based on the determination that the signal strength magnitude has been measured at least the threshold amount of times.
2. The device of claim 1, wherein the control circuit is further configured to: measure the second signal strength magnitude of the communication channel; compare the second signal strength magnitude to the transmission threshold having the second value; on a condition that the second signal strength magnitude is less than the transmission threshold, transmit the message on the communication channel via the communication circuit; and on a condition that the second signal strength magnitude is not less than the transmission threshold, increase the transmission threshold by the increment from the second value to a third value.
3. The device of claim 1, wherein the first value is configured based on a message received at the control circuit via the communication circuit.
4. The device of claim 1, wherein the control circuit is further configured to: compare the second value of the transmission threshold to a maximum threshold value; and on a condition that the second value of the transmission threshold is not less than the maximum threshold value, transmit the message on the communication channel via the communication circuit.

5. The device of claim 1, wherein the control circuit is further configured to: determine a background signal strength magnitude for the communication channel; and determine the first value based on the background signal strength magnitude.
6. The device of claim 1, wherein the control circuit is further configured to: determine a priority context of the message based on at least one of a device type of the device, a content of the message, a transmission type of the message, a network role of the device, and a quality of a network communication link associated with the device; and determine the first value of the transmission threshold based on the priority context of the message.
7. The device of claim 6, wherein the control circuit is configured to determine whether the message is a latency-critical message or a latency non-critical message based on the priority context, wherein the first value of the transmission threshold is set to a higher value when the message is determined to be the latency-critical message to achieve a latency below a predefined latency threshold, and wherein the first value of the transmission threshold is set to a lower value when the message is determined to be the latency non-critical message to allow the latency to be above the predefined latency threshold.
8. The device of claim 7, wherein the priority context includes the device type of the device, wherein the device is a remote control device or an occupancy sensor device, and wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-critical message based on the device being the remote control device or the occupancy sensor device.
9. The device of claim 7, wherein the priority context includes the content of the message, wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-critical message based on the content of the message including control instructions for controlling an electrical load, and wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the content of the message including a state of an electrical load or a load control environment.
10. The device of claim 9, wherein the electrical load is a lighting load, wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-critical message based on the content of the message including control instructions configured to cause greater than a threshold amount of change in a lighting intensity or color of the lighting load, and wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the content of the message including control instructions configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in the lighting intensity or the color of the lighting load.
11. The device of claim 7, wherein the priority context includes the transmission type of the message, wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-critical message based on the transmission type being a unicast message, and wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-non-critical message based on the transmission type being a multicast message or a broadcast message.
12. The device of claim 7, wherein the priority context includes the network role of the device, wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-critical message based on the network role being a router device, and wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the network role being an end device.
13. The device of claim 7, wherein the priority context includes the quality of the network communication link associated with the device, wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency-critical message based on the quality of the network communication link being below a threshold, and wherein the control circuit is configured to determine that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the quality of the network communication link being above the threshold.
14. The device of claim 1, wherein the control circuit is further configured to determine a value of the increment based on one or more of a number of previous attempts of transmitting the message,

the first signal strength magnitude, a difference between the first signal strength magnitude and the transmission threshold, an amount of near-channel interference associated with the communication channel, a link quality associated with the communication channel, or a path loss associated with the communication channel.

15. A method comprising: setting a transmission threshold to a first value; measuring a first signal strength magnitude of the communication channel; comparing the first signal strength magnitude to the transmission threshold; on a condition that the first signal strength magnitude is less than the transmission threshold, transmitting a message on the communication channel; and on a condition that the first signal strength magnitude is not less than the transmission threshold, increasing the transmission threshold by an increment from the first value to a second value to which a second signal strength magnitude of the communication channel will be compared to determine whether to transmit the message on the communication channel; determining that the signal strength magnitude of the communication channel has been measured at least a threshold amount of times; and transmitting the message via the communication circuit on the communication channel based on the determination that the signal strength magnitude has been measured at least the threshold amount of times.

16. The method of claim 15, further comprising: measuring a second signal strength magnitude of the communication channel; comparing the second signal strength magnitude to the transmission threshold having the second value; on a condition that the second signal strength magnitude is less than the transmission threshold, transmitting the message on the communication channel; and on a condition that the second signal strength magnitude is not less than the transmission threshold, increasing the transmission threshold by the increment from the second value to a third value.

17. The method of claim 15, further comprising: comparing the second value of the transmission threshold to a maximum threshold value; and on a condition that the second value of the transmission threshold is not less than the maximum threshold value, transmitting the message on the communication channel via the communication circuit.

18. The method of claim 15, further comprising: determining a background signal strength magnitude for the communication channel; and determining the first value based on the background signal strength magnitude.

19. The method of claim 15, further comprising: determining a priority context of the message based on one or more of a device type of a device transmitting the message, a content of the message, a transmission type of the message, a network role of the device, and a network communication link associated with the device; and determining the first value of the transmission threshold based on the priority context of the message.

20. The method of claim 19, further comprising determining whether the message is a latency-critical message or a latency non-critical message based on the priority context, wherein the first value of the transmission threshold is set to a higher value when the message is determined to be the latency-critical message to achieve a latency below a predefined latency threshold, and wherein the first value of the transmission threshold is set to a lower value when the message is determined to be the latency non-critical message to allow the latency to be above the predefined latency threshold.

21. The method of claim 20, wherein the priority context includes the device type of the device, wherein the device is a remote control device or an occupancy sensor device, and wherein the method further comprises determining that the message is the latency-critical message based on the device being the remote control device or the occupancy sensor device.

22. The method of claim 20, wherein the priority context includes the content of the message, wherein the method further comprises at least one of: determining that the message is the latency-critical message based on the content of the message including control instructions for controlling an electrical load; and determining that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the content of the message including a state of an electrical load or a load control environment.

23. The method of claim 22, wherein the electrical load is a lighting load, and wherein the method further comprises at least one of: determining that the message is the latency-critical message based on the content of the message including control instructions configured to cause greater than a threshold amount of change in a lighting intensity or color of the lighting load; and determining that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the content of the message including control instructions configured to cause less than the threshold amount of change in the lighting intensity or the color of the lighting load.

24. The method of claim 20, wherein the priority context includes the quality of the network communication link associated with the device, wherein the method further comprises at least one of: determining that the message is the latency-critical message based on the quality of the network communication link being below a threshold, and determining that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the quality of the network communication link being above the threshold.

25. The method of claim 20, wherein the priority context includes the transmission type of the message, wherein the method further comprises at least one of: determining that the message is the latency-critical message based on the transmission type being a unicast message, and determining that the message is the latency-non-critical message based on the transmission type being a multicast message or a broadcast message.

26. The method of claim 20, wherein the priority context includes the network role of the device, wherein the method further comprises at least one of: determining that the message is the latency-critical message based on the network role being a router device; and determining that the message is the latency non-critical message based on the network role being an end device.
